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ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

GENERAL STUDIES (P) TEST –3797 (2023)

Q 1.B

- Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, a member of the Bhonsle Maratha clan, carved out his own independent kingdom from the declining Adilshahi sultanate of Bijapur which formed the genesis of the Maratha Empire.
- **Shivaji's Administration:**
 - **Revenue Administration:** Assessment of land revenue was based on measurement. The kathi of Ambar was adopted as the measuring rod. The Swarajya was divided into a number of revenue divisions, called prants consisting of two or more districts. **Chauth and sardeshmukhi** were collected not on his swarajya but on an undefined belt of land which was legally part of the Mughal empire or the Deccan states. **Chauth was one-fourth of the land revenue** paid to the Marathas so as not be subjected to Maratha raids. **Sardeshmukhi was an additional levy of 10 per cent on those lands of Maharashtra** over which the Marathas claimed hereditary rights, but which formed part of the Mughal empire.
 - **Military Administration:** Ordinary soldiers were paid in cash, but the big chiefs and **military commanders were paid through the grant of revenues of saranjam or mokasa (jagirs/land grants)**. All ministers, except the nyayadhish and the pandit rao had to participate in war. The hierarchy of army officials was -- sar-i-nauhat (senapati), panch hazari, jumladar, havaladar and naik.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 2.A

- **Grameen Udyami Project:** It is a unique multiskilling project, **funded by National Skills Development Corporation (NSDC)** that aims to train 450 tribal students in Madhya Pradesh and Jharkhand. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The project is **being implemented in six states**— Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Gujarat. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- **Significance:** There is a dire need to increase ownership at the tribal level so that there is awareness built around such schemes and initiatives. As there is so much potential and ability in the tribal youth, all we need to do is lay down the right avenues for them to use their talent in the right places. This initiative will provide economic empowerment to our tribal population.
- **Objectives:**
 - Increase in rural/local economy.
 - Enhance employment opportunities.
 - Reduce forced migration due to lack of local opportunities.
 - Conservation of natural resources.

Q 3.A

- **Recently, researchers at the Council of Scientific & Industrial Research-Indian Institute of Petroleum (CSIR-IIP), Dehradun, have identified a white-rot fungus Trametesmaxima IIPLC-32, which has the potential to cause microbial remediation (bioremediation) of pyrene.**
- Pyrene, possessing four benzene rings, belongs to the highly toxic class of PAHs, with carcinogenic and mutagenic properties. It gets lodged into the environmental matrices like soil, water and atmosphere, resulting in widespread environmental pollution, necessitating adequate remediation of contaminated environmental matrices.
- According to researchers, growing on dead plants, this fungus causes pyrene degradation using special enzymes. This fungus is also capable of removing toxic, recalcitrant, and carcinogenic polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons (PAHs) from the environment.

- Polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons (PAHs) are a class of chemicals that occur naturally in coal, crude oil, and gasoline. They result from burning coal, oil, gas, wood, garbage, and tobacco. PAHs can bind to or form small particles in the air. High heat when cooking meat and other foods will form PAHs.
- The PAHs are ubiquitous environmental pollutants originating from multiple sources, including combustion of petrogenic fossil fuels, and incomplete incineration of municipal wastes and biomass.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 4.A

- In **1534 AD** the Portuguese gained possession of Bombay, after the **Treaty of Bassein** was signed between them and Bahadur Shah of the Gujarat Sultanate. In 1612, a battle was fought between the British and the Portuguese at Surat for the possession of Bombay, which ended the Portuguese monopoly over trade in India.
- In 1661, under the **Treaty of Whitehall**, Bombay changed hands as it was presented to King Charles II as part of the dowry, when he married Princess Catherine de Braganza of Portugal. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Treaty included a secret provision that it would be used to protect the Portuguese settlements in India. It involved a mutual **defence pact against** the aggressive and expanding **Dutch** East India Company.
- **The French East India Company was founded on 1 September 1664** to compete with the English and Dutch trading companies in the East Indies. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 5.B

- **Recently NASA has announced that the ISS spacecraft will cease operations in 2031, after which it will fall out of orbit and plunge into the waters of the South Pacific Ocean.**
- The International Space Station (ISS) is the largest modular space station currently in low Earth orbit.
- **It is a multinational collaborative project involving five participating space agencies: NASA (United States), Roscosmos (Russia), JAXA (Japan), ESA (Europe), and CSA (Canada). Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
- The ownership and use of the space station is established by intergovernmental treaties and agreements.
- The station serves as a microgravity and space environment research laboratory in which scientific research is conducted in astrobiology, astronomy, meteorology, physics, and other fields.
- The ISS is suited for testing the spacecraft systems and equipment required for possible future long-duration missions to the Moon and Mars.
- For over two decades, the International Space Station (ISS) has been orbiting Earth at a speed of about eight kilometres per second, while an international crew of astronauts and cosmonauts onboard conducted groundbreaking scientific investigations that have thrown open the doors for deep space exploration.

Q 6.A

- The **Bombay Presidency Association** was started by **Badraddin Tyabji, Pheroze Shah Mehta and K.T. Telang** in 1885. It was founded in response to **Lytton's reactionary policies and the Ilbert Bill controversy**. The association has always had cordial relations with the Poona Sarvajanik Sabha. The Bombay Presidency Association, the Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, the Madras Mahajana Sabha, and the Indian Association of Calcutta **sent a joint deputation to England in September 1885 to present India's case to the British electorate**. It championed Indian interests and also hosted the first meeting of the Indian National Congress in Bombay at the end of 1885. **Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- The **Madras Mahajan Sabha** was founded in 1884 by M. Viraraghavachari, **B. Subramaniya Aiyer** and P. Anandachari. The Mahajana Sabha held its first conference between 29 December 1884 and 2 January 1885. It demanded fundamental rights of Indians such as national freedom and other common social issues for the welfare of our fellowmen since 1884. In September 1885, the Sabha in collaboration with the Bombay Presidency Association and the Indian Association sent a delegation to England. On April 22, 1930, the **Sabha organized the Salt Satyagraha movement in Madras' George Town, Esplanade, High Court, and Beach areas. Hence, pair 2 is correctly matched.**
- The **Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha** was formed in **1836** by associates of **Raja Rammohan Roy. Raja Ram Mohan Roy died in 1833. Prasanna Kr. Thakur, Kalinath Chowdhury, Dwarkanath Tagore**, and others were the associates of Raja Rammohan Roy who founded the Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha in 1836. The Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha is regarded as the earliest political organisation in India. It sought to increase the association of Indians in the administration, the spread of education, pushing forward Indian demands to the British parliament. **Hence pair 3 is not correctly matched.**

Q 7.B

- The policy of **financial devolution** during the British colonial rule was initiated by **Lord Mayo (1869-1872)** and continued further by Lord Ripon (1880-1884).
- In 1877 the provincial governments were given the control of expenditure on financial services like excise, land revenue reforms, law and justice etc., and also handed over some specified sources of revenue (e.g., excise, license fee etc.) from their respective provinces.
- In **1882 a system of 'Divided Heads' was introduced** i.e., income from subjects like Excise, Stamps, Forests etc. **was divided in equal proportion among the Central and Provincial governments.** The system of "Divided Heads" remained operative till it was modified by the Government of India Act, 1919. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Governor General Lord Ripon** is regarded as the **father of local self-government in India.** His **resolution of 1882** on local self-government is significant in this regard. It provided for
 - The development of local bodies advocated improving the administration.
 - The policy of administering local affairs through urban and rural local bodies charged with definite duties and entrusted with suitable sources of revenues.
 - Non-officials to be in majority in these bodies, who could be elected if the officials thought that it was possible to introduce elections
 - **Non-officials to act as chairpersons to these bodies. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - Official interference to be reduced to the minimum

Q 8.A

- Before the Indian nationalist intelligentsia began to associate itself with working-class agitations, there were also some early attempts at organized efforts to improve the condition of the workers. These efforts were made as early as the 1870s by philanthropists.
- In 1878, **Sorabjee Shapoorji Bengalee** tried unsuccessfully to introduce a **Bill in the Bombay Legislative Council to limit the working hours for labour.** Hence, **statement 1 is correct.**
- In Bengal, **Sasipada Banerjee**, a Brahmo Social reformer, **set up a Workingmen's Club in 1870 and published a monthly journal called Bharat Sramjeebi (Indian Labour), with the primary idea of educating the workers.** Hence, **statement 2 is not correct.**
- In Bombay, **Narayan Meghajee Lokhanday** brought out an **Anglo-Marathi weekly called Dina Bandhu** (Friend of the Poor) in 1880, and started the Bombay Mill and Millhands' Association in 1890. Lokhanday held meetings of workers and in one instance sent a memorial signed by 5,500 mill workers, to the Bombay Factory Commission, putting forward some minimum workers' demands. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 9.C

- **Recently** Lok Sabha Speaker unveiled the statues of **Swami Vivekananda** and Maharashtra-born freedom fighter and agriculturalist **Pandurang Khankhoje (1883-1967) in Mexico.**
- **Pandurang Khankhoje:** Pandurang Khankhoje was born in Wardha, Maharashtra, in the late 19th century. He came in contact with other revolutionaries early on. Hindu reformer Swami Dayanand and his Arya Samaj movement, which called for a spirit of reform and social change, became the hero of a young student group led by Khankhoje. Khankhoje was an ardent admirer of the French Revolution and of the American War of Independence. Before leaving India for training abroad, he visited Bal Gangadhar Tilak. Khankhoje decided to go abroad for training in revolutionary methods and militaristic strategy. After spending time with nationalists from Japan and China, Khankhoje eventually moved to the US, where he enrolled in college as a student of agriculture. A year later, he joined the Mount Tamalpais Military Academy in California.
- **Khankhoje & Ghadar Party:** In the US, Khankhoje met Lala Har Dayal, the Indian intellectual teacher at Stanford University. Har Dayal had begun a propaganda campaign, publishing a newspaper that featured patriotic songs and articles in the vernacular languages of India. This was the seed from which the Ghadar Party would emerge. **Khankhoje was one of the founding members of the Ghadar Party,** established by Indians living abroad in 1913, mostly belonging to Punjab. Its aim was to lead a revolutionary fight against the British in India.
- **Connections with Mexicans in the US:** At the military academy in the US, Khankhoje met many people from Mexico. **Khankhoje was inspired by "The Mexican Revolution of 1910" which led to the overthrow of the dictatorial regime.** While he was reaching out to Indians working on farms in the US with the aim of discussing the idea of Indian independence with them, he met with Mexican workers as well. He reached out to Bhikaji Cama in Paris, and met with Vladimir Lenin in Russia among other leaders,

seeking support for India's Independence. He was facing deportation from Europe and he could not go to India, so he sought shelter in Mexico. **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

- **Lala Har Dayal:** In London, he met and was influenced by Shyamji Krishna Varma, the lawyer-revolutionary who founded the Indian Home Rule Society, India House, and The Indian Sociologist in London. Har Dayal also came under the influence of V D Savarkar and Madame Cama. He was greatly enthused by the assassination attempt on Viceroy Hardinge in India and he addressed the Indian community there and asked them to fight for independence by force. He **founded the Ghadar Party in 1913**. His works include 'Thoughts in Education', 'Social Conquest of Hindu Race', 'Forty-Four Months in Germany and Turkey', 'Hints for Self Culture', 'Bodhisatva Doctrines', etc.
- **Ganda Singh Phangureh:** His hometown was Ferozepur in India, was a prominent member of the Ghadar Party. He spent some time in Hankou, China, where he met Chiang Kai-shek. in 1926, and M. N. Roy, in 1927.
- **HARNAM SINGH TUNDILAT:** He was a founding member of the Ghadar Party and was born in the Hoshiarpur district of Punjab. His father Gurdit Singh was a peasant of modest means. In his village Dharamshala, he learned to read the Gurmukhi script. Sohan Singh Bhakna, President of the Ghadar Party, directed Harnam Singh to write a letter to Lala Har Dayal and invite him to take over the responsibility of publishing the Ghadar paper. He complied, and Har Dayal agreed to edit the newspaper. On 1 November 1913, the first issue of the Ghadar in Urdu was published. Lala Har Dayal was the first editor, with Kartar Singh Sarabha and Raghubir Dayal serving as assistant editors. Harnam Singh was later invited to join the editorial board, along with a few others. Harnam Singh contributed patriotic poems for the Ghadar newspaper. He also served as a bodyguard for the party's General Secretary, Har Dayal.

Q 10.B

- Recently, the **Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act, 2022**, which was passed by Parliament in April this year, came into force in August 2022. **It replaces the Identification of Prisoners Act, 1920**, a colonial-era law, and authorizes police officers to take measurements of people convicted, arrested, or facing trial in criminal cases. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Identification of Prisoners Act, 1920 allows police officers to collect certain identifiable information (fingerprints and footprints) of persons including convicts and arrested persons. Also, a Magistrate may order measurements or photographs of a person to be taken to aid the investigation of an offense. In case of acquittal or discharge of the person, all material must be destroyed.
- **The National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) will be the central agency to maintain the records.**
- It will share the data with law enforcement agencies. States/UTs may notify agencies to collect, preserve, and share data in their respective jurisdictions. **The data collected will be retained in digital or electronic form for 75 years. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- **Under both the 1920 Act and the 2022 Act, resistance or refusal to give data will be considered an offence of obstructing a public servant from doing his duty. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 11.B

- The **Madras Native Association was established in 1852** as a platform for educated Indians to protest against any injustice on the part of the British. It was the first Indian political organization in the Madras Presidency.
- **It was set up as a branch of the British Indian Association of Calcutta.** The Madras Association also sent a petition to the Parliament on the eve of the passing of the Charter Act of 1853 making demands similar to that of the British Indian Association and the Bombay Association right from its inception was worked by some officials, possessed very little vitality, had hardly any hold upon the public mind and languished into obscurity after 1857.
- The **British Indian Association of Calcutta was formed in 1851** through the merger of the Landholders' Society and the Bengal British India Society.
- Other important political association in Madras was the **Madras Mahajan Sabha** founded in 1884 by M. Viraraghavachari, B. Subramaniya Aiyer and P. Anandacharlu.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 12.A

- The characteristic feature of moderate nationalism was an almost obsessive invocation of Indian poverty. . For the last three decades of the nineteenth century, and into the twentieth, "poverty" was the biggest stick with which the Congress beat the British.

- Apart from Naoroji's relentless publicizing of Indian poverty and the "drain of wealth" from India to England, there was a veritable flood of literature investigating the subject.
- Some of the landmarks in this included
 - **Prithwis Chandra Ray's The Poverty Problem in India (1895). Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**
 - William Digby's "Prosperous British India (1901)
 - **Romesh Chandra Dutt's England and India: A Record of Progress during a Hundred Years (1897)**
 - ✓ **Romesh Chandra Dutt, a retired ICS officer, published The Economic History of India** at the beginning of the 20th century in which he examined in minute detail the entire economic record of colonial rule since 1757. **Hence pair 3 is not correctly matched.**
 - **Subramanya Iyer's Some Economic Aspects of British Rule in India (1903). Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- In the press and in books, in Congress speeches and resolutions, India's poverty and the "drain of wealth" were' constantly discussed and the blame was laid at Britain's door.
- Leaders like G.V. Joshi, G. Subramaniya Iyer, G.K. Gokhale, Prithwis Chandra Ray and hundreds of other political workers and journalists analysed every aspect of the economy and subjected the entire range of economic issues and colonial economic policies to minute scrutiny.
 - They raised basic questions regarding the nature and purpose of British rule. Eventually, they were able to trace the process of the colonialization of the Indian economy and conclude that colonialism was the main obstacle to India's economic development.

Q 13.A

- **In 1882, the Government appointed a commission under the chairmanship of W.W. Hunter to review the progress of education in the country since the Despatch of 1854. The Hunter Commission mostly confined its recommendations to primary and secondary education.**
 - It emphasized that state's special care is required for the extension and improvement of primary education and that primary education should be imparted through vernacular.
 - It recommended the transfer of control of primary education to newly set up district and municipal boards.
 - It recommended that secondary (High School) education should have two divisions— literary—leading up to university and vocational—for commercial careers.
 - It drew attention to inadequate facilities for female education, especially outside presidency towns and made recommendations for its spread.
- **The Sadler commission was set up in 1917** to study and report on problems of Calcutta University but its recommendations were applicable more or less to other universities also. It reviewed the entire field from school education to university education. It held the view that, for the improvement of university education, the improvement of secondary education was a necessary pre-condition. Its observations were as follows:
 - School course should cover 12 years. Students should enter university after an intermediate stage (rather than matric) for a three-year degree course in university.
 - A separate board of secondary and intermediate education should be set up for the administration and control of secondary and intermediate education.
 - There should be less rigidity in framing university regulations.
 - A university should function as centralized, unitary residential-teaching autonomous body, rather than as scattered, affiliated colleges.
 - Female education, applied scientific and technological education, teachers' training including those for professional and vocational colleges should be extended.
- **The Hartog Committee was set up in 1929** to report on the development of education. Its main recommendations were as follows.
 - Emphasis should be given to primary education but there need be no hasty expansion or compulsion in education.
 - Only deserving students should go in for high school and intermediate stage, while average students should be diverted to vocational courses after VIII standard.
 - For improvements in the standards of university education, admissions should be restricted.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 14.A

- The **Treaty of Amritsar (1809)** was signed on April 25, 1809, between **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** (1780 – 1839) and the **British East India Company**. It was a pact between **Charles T. Metcalfe and Maharaja Ranjit Singh**. Maharaja Ranjit Singh was the founder of the Sikh Empire. He was the son of Mahan Singh,

the leader of the Sukarchakia misl. Ranjit Singh brought under control the area extending from the Sutlej to the Jhelum. He conquered Lahore in 1799 and Amritsar in 1802. Ranjit Singh proved to be an efficient administrator. He greatly modernised his army with the help of Europeans. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**

- Ranjit Singh died in 1839. His successors could not keep the state intact and, soon enough, the British took control over it. **Maharaja Daleep Singh was the son and successor of Maharaja Ranjit Singh** who came to the throne in 1843.
- As per the provisions of the **Treaty of Amritsar (1809)**, the river Sutlej was the boundary between the British and the state of Punjab. The treaty settled Indo-Sikh relations for a generation. The immediate occasion was the French threat to northwestern India, following Napoleon's Treaty of Tilsit with Russia (1807) and Ranjit's attempt to bring the area around Sutlej states under his control. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The **treaty of Amritsar did not have any provision regarding the British resident at the royal court of Punjab**. The **treaty of Lahore (1846)** signed after the first Anglo- Sikh War (1845-46), **provided for the stationing of a British resident at Lahore**. The state of Punjab was annexed by Lord Dalhousie in 1849 after the Second Anglo- Sikh War (1848-49) and the eleven-year-old Maharaja, Daleep Singh was pensioned off to England. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 15.D

- **Recently, Durga Puja in Kolkata has been inscribed on UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) of Humanity.**
 - Durga Puja is a five-day festival that begins on the fifth night of the nine-day Navratri festival and ends on the tenth day, which is Dashami.
 - During this time, people collectively worship and invoke Goddess Durga, who is regarded as the feminine energy of the cosmos, also known as 'Shakti'. It is one of the largest cultural carnivals and street art festivals in the country.
 - During this time, intricately-designed clay models of the Goddess are worshiped in 'pandals' and pavilions where people get together.
- **Sankirtana:**
 - The Sankirtana is a Manipur ritual singing, drumming, and dancing art form. This art form is performed to commemorate religious occasions as well as different stages in the lives of Manipuri Vaishnavites.
 - **This unique cultural heritage of Manipur was inscribed in the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity of UNESCO in 2013.**
- **Kumbh Mela:**
 - It is the largest peaceful congregation of pilgrims on earth, during which participants bathe or take a dip in a sacred river.
 - It takes place on the banks of the Godavari river in Nashik, the Shipra river in Ujjain, the Ganges in Haridwar, and the confluence of the Ganges, Yamuna, and the mythical Saraswati river in Prayag. The confluence is referred to as the 'Sangam'.
 - As it is held in four different cities in India, it involves different social and cultural activities, making this a culturally diverse festival.
 - While technically, it is to be held in each of the aforementioned locations once every 12 years, sometimes, the mela can happen only a year apart at the sites.
 - It should also be known that in between, around the sixth year, the Ardh Kumbh Mela (also known as the half mela) is held. In addition to that, in Allahabad, every year the Magh Mela is celebrated in the month of Magh (mid-January to February, as per the Hindu calendar) at the Sangam.
 - This Maagh Mela is also referred to as the Ardh Kumbh Mela and Kumbh Mela when it happens in the sixth and twelfth years, respectively.
 - Kumbh Mela in Haridwar is being held after 11 years — not the usual 12 — because of specific auspicious dates. In fact, this is the first time in 80 years that such a phenomenon has happened.
 - **Kumbh Mela comes under UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.**
- **Garba:**
 - Garba is a form of dance, as well as a religious and social event. It originated in the villages of Gujarat, where it was performed in communal gathering places in the center of the village which was attended by the entire community.
 - In Gujarat, it is celebrated with nine nights of dance as a form of worship and worship. Garba is also performed during social events like weddings and parties.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

- **About the list of the intangible cultural heritage of UNESCO**
 - UNESCO's prestigious list is made up of intangible heritage elements that help to showcase the diversity of cultural heritage and raise awareness of its importance.
 - It was established in 2008 after the Convention for the Protection of Intangible Cultural Heritage, 2003 came into force.
 - It compiles two lists viz. Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity and the List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in Need of Urgent Protection.

Q 16.A

- **The Union environment ministry recently announced that India has added 10 more wetlands, taking the total Ramsar sites to 64.**
- **The new sites include six wetlands from Tamil Nadu and one each from Goa, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh and Odisha. They include:**
- **Koonthankulam Bird Sanctuary, a man-made wetland in Tirunelveli district of Tamil Nadu. This is the largest reserve for breeding resident and migratory water birds in south India and an important bird and biodiversity area forming part of the central Asian flyway. The wetland also irrigates about 190 acres of paddy. The painted stork is the major attraction in this sanctuary. Other notable waterbird species include Indian pond heron (*Ardeola grayii*), Eurasian wigeon (*Anas penelope*), spot-billed pelican (*Pelecanus philippensis*), oriental darter (*Anhinga melanogaster*) and Northern pintail (*Anas acuta*). Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- **The Nanda Lake in Goa has freshwater marshes that lie adjacent to one of the major rivulets of the Zuari river. This enables the locals to store water during the off-monsoon season. The stored water is also utilised to cultivate paddy downstream of the lake and supports fishing and recreation. The lake is a habitat for Black-headed ibis, Common kingfisher, Wire-tailed swallow, Bronze-winged jacana, Brahminy kite among others.**
- **The Satkosia gorge, which has also been included, spreads along the Mahanadi river in Odisha. Established in 1976 as a wildlife sanctuary, Satkosia is the meeting point of two biogeographic regions of India – the Deccan Peninsula and the Eastern Ghats, contributing immense biodiversity, the ministry said.**
- **The Satkosia gorge wetland is a mosaic of marshes and evergreen forests. The forests of these catchments play a vital role in the prevention of the gorge siltation. They also help in maintaining a desirable depth of water crucial for the endangered gharial population.**
- **The Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve (GoMBR) is located on the southeastern coastline. It is unique for its rich marine environment. The reserve area is also home to several globally important and highly threatened species such as the Dugong, whale shark, seahorses, balanoglossus, green sea turtle, hawksbill turtle, dolphins, sacred chanks, etc.**
- **"Ramsar Sites are designated because they meet the criteria for identifying wetlands of international importance. The first criterion refers to sites containing representative, rare or unique wetland types, and the other eight cover sites of international importance for conserving biological diversity. These criteria emphasize the importance the convention places on sustaining biodiversity," the convention's website states.**

Q 17.D

- **Puga Valley in the Ladakh region of Jammu & Kashmir was one of the areas which showed significant potential for geothermal energy. Puga lies in the south-eastern part of Ladakh and forms a part of the Himalayan geothermal belt. Recently, ONGC has embarked on a journey to tap geothermal energy from the Puga Valley which is located at an altitude of over 14,000 feet, off the road to Chumar. This will be India's first geothermal energy project and also the world's highest. Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- **The Muppandal Wind Farm is India's largest operational onshore wind farm. This project located in Kanyakumari district, Tamil Nadu. The project was developed by Tamil Nadu Energy Development Agency. Its installed capacity is 1,500 MW, which makes it the 3rd-largest operational onshore wind farm in the world. Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**
- **Bhadla Solar Park is the world's largest solar park located in India which is spread over a total area of 14,000 acres in Bhadla, Phalodi tehsil, Jodhpur district, Rajasthan, India. Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**



Q 18.C

- **Surendranath Banerjea** (1848-1925) was born on 10 November 1848 in Calcutta. He graduated from Calcutta University in 1868 and proceeded to England to compete for the Indian Civil Services. **He cleared the Imperial Civil Service (ICS) but was not allowed to work in the administration.** He was declared disqualified by the British.
- He was the **first to familiarize an Indian audience with Giuseppe Mazzini (1805-1872)**, the pioneer of Italian unification. Banerjea was the first leader to use material from Indian and foreign histories to instil a sense of patriotism in his audience. On his return to India in June 1875, Banerjea began his new career as a Professor of English. In 1876 he founded the **Indian Association**. He was among the earliest leaders who attempted to forge all India links among the political associations in different parts of India.
- The Indian Association of Calcutta tried to open branches in the other two presidencies with a view to sending a joint petition to the British parliament on the eve of the renewal of the Company's Charter. The **Native Press Association was founded by the Indian journalists in the 1870s** and **Surendranath Banerjea was chosen as its first secretary**. The Indian Association organised a National conference in Calcutta in 1883 and another was scheduled in December 1885. He became a **member of the Imperial Legislative Assembly in 1921** and was knighted the same year.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 19.A

- **The Ministry of Commerce and Industry is planning to replace the 80-year-old Coffee Act with the new Coffee (Promotion and Development Bill), 2022, which has been listed for the Monsoon Session of Parliament.**
- The Coffee Act, 1942 was first introduced during World War II, in order to protect the struggling Indian coffee industry from the economic downturn caused by the war. The government is now trying to scrap the law because it claims that many of the provisions have become redundant.
- In the 1930s, the Indian coffee industry was facing significant problems, such as large-scale damage by pests and diseases, and the global economic downturn caused by the Great Depression. With coffee planters making significant losses, the government passed the Coffee Cess Act (XIV of 1935) and established the first Indian Cess Committee in November 1935, in order to promote the sale of coffee and increase consumption of Indian coffee at home and abroad.

- These problems from the 1930s were compounded with the outbreak of World War II, as low demands and a loss of foreign markets led to a sharp decline in coffee prices. Since the Cess Committee was not able to deal with the crisis faced by the industry, **the government formed the Coffee Board, through the introduction of the Coffee Act, 1942, under the control of the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.** The purpose of the Act was to provide for the development of the coffee industry. **Hence statement 1 is correct and statement 2 is not correct.**
- Before India liberalised its economy in 1991, the Coffee Board controlled the marketing of the commodity in its entirety, both in India and abroad. It was previously in charge of collecting, storage, processing and sale for the growers as well. **The Coffee Act introduced a pooling system,** where each planter was required to distribute their entire crop to a surplus pool managed by the Board, apart from the small quantities that were allowed for domestic use and seed production. The grower was required to take the harvested and dried coffee to a curing factory, where they would receive an advance. Registered private contractors would clean, sort and grade the quality of coffee on a point system, for which they would receive a fee from the Coffee Board which would be later deducted from its payment to the grower. The Board then marketed 70% of the total pool for export and 30% for domestic markets, and sold them in separate auctions. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 20.D

- The Eka Movement is a peasant movement that started in Lucknow, and soon spread to Hardoi, Unnao, and Sitapur districts and became a strong force. The initial thrust was provided by Congress and Khilafat leaders and the movement grew under the name of the Eka or unity movement. **The main grievances here related to the extraction of a rent that was generally fifty percent higher than the recorded rent,** the oppression of the thekedars to whom the work of rent- collection was farmed out and the practice of share-rents.
- **The Eka meetings were marked by a religious ritual in which a hole that represented the river Ganges was dug in the ground and filled with water,** a priest was brought in to preside and the assembled peasants owed that they would pay only the recorded rent but pay it on time, would not leave when ejected, would refuse to do forced labour, would give no help to criminals and abide by the panchayat decisions.
- **The Eka Movement, however, soon developed its own grassroots leadership in the form of Madari Pasi and other low-caste leaders who were not particularly inclined to accept the discipline of non-violence** that the Congress and Khilafat leaders urged.
- As a result, the movement's contact with the nationalists diminished and it went its own way. However, **unlike the earlier Kisan Sabha a movement that was based almost solely on tenants, the Eka Movement included in its ranks many small zamindars** who found themselves disenchanted with the Government because of its heavy land revenue demand. **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**
- By March 1922, however, severe repression on the part of the authorities succeeded in bringing the Eka Movement to its end.

Q 21.C

- Alarmed at the increasing strength of the trade union movement under the extremist influence, the government resorted to legislative restrictions. It passed the Public Safety Ordinance (1929) and the Trade Disputes Act (TDA), 1929.
- The TDA, 1929 provided for
 - the compulsory appointment of Courts of Inquiry and Consultation Boards for settling industrial disputes
 - and made illegal the strikes in public utility services like posts, railways, water and electricity unless each individual worker planning to go on strike gave advance notice of one month to the administration;
 - forbade trade union activity of coercive or purely political nature and even sympathetic strikes. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt were asked to throw a bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly on 8 April 1929 against the passage of the Public Safety Bill and the Trade Disputes Bill which would reduce the civil liberties of citizens in general and workers in particular. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 22.B

- **Stablecoins are cryptocurrency tokens which are attached or "pegged" to the value of assets like dollars, pounds, euros, or even gold and oil. These assets are popular in economies where the official currency is rapidly losing value. Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

- **Recently in May 2022, the TerraUSD [UST] stablecoin - where every UST was meant to be worth 1 USD - collapsed, blasting billions of dollars in value off the market.**
- Citing the “recent turmoil” in the crypto market, the Financial Stability Board or FSB, an organisation that advises on matters relating to international finance, underlined the need for common domestic and international standards in order to regulate crypto assets, including stablecoins.
- According to the FSB report, Stablecoins should be captured by robust regulations and supervision of relevant authorities if they are to be adopted as a widely used means of payment or otherwise play an important role in the financial system.
- The Switzerland-based organisation also highlighted the need for regulatory standards to combat money laundering, terrorist-financing, and to enforce travel rules for crypto moving across borders.
- The G20 major economies - including India - and the European Commission are all members of the Financial Stability Board.

Q 23.B

- The Indian Rebellion of 1857 was a major uprising in India in 1857–58 against the rule of the British East India Company, which functioned as a sovereign power on behalf of the British Crown.
- Though the revolt was formidable and widespread though the revolt was, it was yet to a great extent localized, limited and ill-organized. The Mutiny was not universal.
- According to Dr. R.C Mazumdar, it was never an all-India character but was localized, restricted, and poorly organised. The **area affected** was Punjab, the United Provinces, **Rohilkhand**, Oudh, the territory between the Narmada and the Chambal, and the Western parts of Bengal and Bihar on the North-East. Sindh was quite, and Rajputana was loyal. **Under Dost Mohammad, Afghanistan was friendly to the British. He refrained from assisting rebels. Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - At **Bareilly, Khan Bahadur**, a descendant of the **former ruler of Rohilkhand**, was placed in command. Not enthusiastic about the pension being granted by the British, he organized an army of 40,000 soldiers and **offered stiff resistance to the British. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- India South of the river Narmada made no movement of importance, though the native regiments mutinied at Kolhapur in the Southern Marathan country and there were also many dangerous outbursts of feelings at Hyderabad, the Nizam's Capital. Central and Eastern Bengal were undisturbed and Nepal rendered the British valuable assistance in putting down the revolt. The **Bombay and Madras armies remained loyal to the British.** Thus, the revolt was only local and not nation-wise. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 24.D

- The early attempts associated with working-class agitations were organized to improve the condition of the workers. These efforts were made as early as the 1870s by philanthropists. **Sasipada Banerjea, a Brahmo Social reformer, set up a Workingmen's Club in 1870** with the primary idea of educating the workers.
- Ahmedabad Textile Labour Association (TLA), with 14,000 workers on its rolls, was perhaps the largest single trade union of the time. **In 1918, Mahatma Gandhi and Anasuya Sarabhai and Shankerlal Banker founded the Ahmadabad textile labour association.**
- The most important development was the **formation of the All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) in 1920** Lokamanya Tilak, who had developed a close association with Bombay work., was one of the moving spirits in the formation of the AITUC, which had Lala Lajpat Rai, the famous Extremist leader from Punjab, as its first president and Dewan Chaman Lal, who was to become a major name in the Indian labour movement, as its General Secretary.
- It was in the second half of the 1920s that consolidation of various Left ideological trends occurred and began to have a significant impact on the national movement. Various Communist groups in different parts of India had by **early 1927 organized themselves into the Workers' and Peasants' Parties (WPP)**, under the leadership of people like S.A. Dange, Muzaffar Ahmed, P.C. Joshi and Sohan Singh Josh. The WPPs, functioning as a left-wing within the Congress, rapidly gained in strength within the Congress organization at the provincial and the all- India levels.
- **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 25.C

- The **Ilbert Bill was proposed in 1883** by the British Government headed by **Lord Ripon. C.P Ilbert, the law member in his council**, introduced in February 1883 what is known as the infamous Ilbert Bill. The bill sought to abolish “judicial disqualification based on race distinctions”. It proposed to give **Indian district magistrates and session judges the power to try European offenders in the mofussil (small towns)**, as they already did in the presidency towns. **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

- However, the bill was **met with opposition from the European community**. In January 1884 Ripon ultimately succumbed to the pressure and **withdrew the bill, substituting it with a milder compromise formula**, which somehow sought to preserve the principle by adding **a provision of trial by a mixed jury in such cases involving European offenders**. It became clear to the nationalists that justice and fair play could not be expected where the interests of the European community were involved. The Ilbert Bill controversy proved an eye-opener to the Indian intelligentsia. It became clear to them that justice and fair play could not be expected where the interests of the European community were involved.

Q 26.D

- The **Battle of Adyar took place on in October 1746**. The battle was between the French East India Company men and Nawab of Arcot forces over the St. George Fort, which was held by the French. It was part of the **First Carnatic War between the English and the French. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - The First Carnatic War (1740-48) was an extension of the Anglo-French War in Europe which was caused by the Austrian War of Succession.
- The English navy under Commodore Bennett seized some French ships to provoke France. **France retaliated by seizing Madras in 1746** with the help of the fleet from the French colony of Mauritius. The **Battle was launched by the Nawab** because he was furious that the French Governor, Joseph Dupleix, had attacked Madras without his permission and captured St. George Fort. Nawab of Arcot, a close ally of the British, set out to regain it by sending troops, led by his son Mahfuz Khan, to Madras.
- French troops, with disciplined firing and then charging with bayonets defeated Mahfuz Khan's troops. So, the Battle of the Adyar River, which began on the morning of October 24, 1746, ended by that evening, with the **French occupation of Fort St. George consolidated. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- Battle of Adyar proved a turning point in the Indian history because for the first time, techniques of 18th century European warfare, developed in Prussia **and tested on the battlefields of France and Flanders, had been tried out in India.**
 - Nothing in the Mughal armoury could match the techniques of 18th century European warfare, particularly the invention of screws for elevating the guns gave the artillery greater precision and increased the fire power of the foot soldier, giving them an edge in the battle against the cavalry.
 - **700 French sepoys defeated the Mughal Army of 10,000 troopers**, which was seen never before in India.

Q 27.D

- **The Danish East India Company**
 - The Danes entered as traders in 1616 but with no ambition to establish an Empire. They managed to secure the Tranquebar port from the Nayak of Tanjore in 1620 and built a fort there. They also established their factories at Masulipatam, Porto Novo and **Shrirampur(1755)**. However, their success was limited, and ultimately they sold off their factories to the English and finally quit India in 1845. **Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- **The Dutch East India Company**
 - The Dutch East India Company was formed in 1602 through a charter. The Dutch were primarily interested in spice trade. Therefore, they paid more attention to the Far East. India was just a trading depot for them. They established their factories at Pulicat (1610), Cambay (1620), Surat and Agra (1621), Hariharpur (1633), Patna (1638). Dacca (1650), Udaiganj (1651), **Chinsura (1653)**, Qasimbazar, Baranagore, Balasore and Negapatam (1659-60). **Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**
- **The French East India Company**
 - The French were late comers to the Eastern trade. The French East India Company was founded in 1664. The first French factory was establish at Surat in 1668. This was the place of prime importance to the English. In 1669, the French established their second factory at Masulipatam. In 1673, they got Pondicherry, and in 1674 the Nawab of Bengal granted them a site near Calcutta where in **1690-92 they built the town of Chandranagore. Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**
- **The Portuguese East India Company**
 - The Portuguese were the very first European naval adventurers on the scene, who had started out on daring sea voyages down the coast of Africa back from 1415 AD. In **1528**, the Sultan of Bengal permitted the Portuguese to establish factories and customs houses in the Port of **Chittagong**. A fort and naval base was established in Firingi Bandar. The settlement grew into the most prominent Eurasian port on the Bay of Bengal during the Age of Discovery. **Hence pair 4 is correctly matched.**

Q 28.D

- **Provisions of the Charter Act of 1793**
 - The British Charter Act of 1793 was the attempt by the British government to regulate the affairs of the East India Company, which had acquired great power and influence in the Indian subcontinent since its first voyage in the early 17th century. It was the first step in the process of nationalisation of the British East India Company.
 - The Act renewed the Company's commercial privileges for next 20 years.
 - The Company, after paying the necessary expenses, interest, dividends, salaries, etc., from the Indian revenues, was to pay 5 lakh pounds annually to the British government.
 - The **royal approval was mandated for the appointment of the governor-general**, the governors, and the commander-in-chief.
 - Senior **officials of the Company were debarred from leaving India** without permission—doing so was treated as resignation.
 - The Company was empowered to give **licenses to individuals** as well as the Company's employees **to trade in India**. The licenses, known as 'privilege' or 'country trade', paved the way for shipments of opium to China.
 - It established the Company's trade monopoly with India. And expanded the scope of the Supreme Court's jurisdiction in India.
 - The **revenue administration was separated from judicial functions**, resulting in the abolition of the Maal Adalats, or revenue courts. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - The **Governor-General** was given more powers. He **could override his council's decision** under certain circumstances. He was also given authority over the governors of Madras and Bombay. When the Governor-General was present in Madras or Bombay, he would supersede in authority over the governors of Madras and Bombay.
- A **sum of one lakh rupees** was to be set aside for the revival, promotion and **encouragement of literature**, learning and science among the natives of India, every year under the **Charter Act of 1813**. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Slavery had been abolished in Britain in 1820 and the Slavery Abolition Act 1833** provided for the gradual abolition of slavery in most parts of the British Empire. In India, **the Indian Slavery Act of 1843 abolished slavery**. **The Act proclaimed slavery to be illegal** and made indulgence in slavery a penal offence. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- However after **the abolition of slavery in 1843**, a system of indentured labour was used to recruit people as plantation labour in other British colonies. Under this system, labourers were hired on contract for a period of five years (indenture) and they could return to their homeland at the end of the period.

Q 29.B

- The **Balutedari system was a reciprocal arrangement between village artisans and the wider village community, for the supply of goods and services** under the Maratha rule in Deccan in the 18th century. The artisans provided services to the villages and in return were paid through the share in agricultural production by the village community.
- The village servants were primarily artisans and formed an important section of the rural society in Deccan. They were called balutedars and their income, which was a share in the agricultural produce, was known as balutas. Balutedars also played an important part in the village council which will be discussed in the next section. The Balutedars were the counterparts of the Kamins of North India. However, compared to the kamins, their status was better off in the Deccan rural society. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
- The system of revenue farming introduced by the Nawabs in Bengal during the 18th century was known as **Ijara farming**. Ijarah system was introduced during the reign of the Mughal emperor Jahandar Shah. It was introduced by his powerful noble Zulfiqar Khan.

Q 30.B

- The Anglo-Mysore Wars were a series of wars fought during the last three decades of the 18th century between the Kingdom of Mysore on the one hand, and the British East India Company (represented chiefly by the Madras Presidency), Maratha Empire, Kingdom of Travancore and the Nizam of Hyderabad on the other. Haider Ali and his successor Tipu Sultan fought a war on four fronts with the British attacking from the west, south and east, while the Nizam's forces attacked from the north.
- **First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69)**
 - The British, after their success in the Battle of Buxar with the nawab of Bengal, signed a treaty with the Nizam of Hyderabad persuading him to give them the Northern Circars for protecting the Nizam from Haidar Ali who already had disputes with the Marathas.

- The Nizam of Hyderabad, the Marathas, and the English allied together against Haidar Ali.
- Haidar changed his strategy and suddenly appeared before the gates of Madras causing complete chaos and panic at Madras. This forced the English to conclude a treaty with Haidar on April 4, **1769** known as the **Treaty of Madras**.
- The treaty provided for the exchange of prisoners and the conquered areas. Haidar Ali was promised the help of the English in case he was attacked by any other power.
- **Second Anglo Mysore War (1780-84)**
 - **Background:** Haidar Ali accused the English of breach of faith and non-observance of the **Treaty of Madras when in 1771** he was attacked by the Marathas, and the English failed to come to his aid. **Haidar Ali** took the help of the **French to set up an arms factory at Dindigul (now in Tamil Nadu)**, and also introduced Western methods of training for his army. Haidar Ali's friendship with the French caused even more concern to the English. They therefore tried to capture Mahe, which Haidar regarded to be under his protection. Haidar considered the English attempt to capture Mahe a direct challenge to his authority. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - Haidar forged an anti-English alliance with the Marathas and the Nizam. He followed it up by an attack in the Carnatic, capturing Arcot, and defeating the English army under Colonel Baillie in 1781.
 - Haidar Ali died of cancer on December 7, 1782. His son, **Tipu Sultan**, carried on the war for one year without any positive outcome. Fed up with an inconclusive war, both English and **Tipu Sultan opted for peace**, negotiating the **Treaty of Mangalore** (March, 1784) under which each party gave back the territories it had taken from the other. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Third Anglo Mysore War (1790-92)**
 - With the support of the Marathas and the Nizam, the English attacked Seringapatam. Tipu offered serious opposition, but the odds were against him. Consequently, he had to pay heavily under the Treaty of Seringapatam.
 - The war ended after the **1792 Siege of Seringapatam** and the signing of the **Treaty of Seringapatam**, under this treaty, nearly half of the Mysorean territory was taken over by the victors. Baramahal, Dindigul and Malabar went to the English, while the **Marathas got the regions surrounding the Tungabhadra** and its tributaries and the **Nizam acquired the areas from the Krishna** to beyond the Pennar. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 31.A

- **Forever chemicals/ Per- and Polyfluoroalkyl Substances (PFAs)**
 - **Why in News?**
 - ✓ According to a recent study, scientists have found that rainwater from many places across the globe is contaminated with Per- and Polyfluoroalkyl Substances (PFAs).
 - ✓ Further, they are called Forever chemicals because of their tendency to stick around in the atmosphere, rainwater, and soil for long periods of time.
 - ✓ PFAs are also listed in the Stockholm Convention.
 - **What are Per- and Polyfluoroalkyl Substances (PFAs)?**
 - ✓ They are man-made chemicals used to make nonstick cookware, water-repellent clothing, stain-resistant fabrics, cosmetics, firefighting foams, and many other products that resist grease, water, and oil.
 - ✓ They can migrate to the soil, water, and air during their production and use.
 - ✓ Most PFAs do not break down, **they remain in the environment for long periods of time. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
 - ✓ Further, some of these PFAs can build up in people and animals if they are repeatedly exposed to the chemicals.
 - **Harmful Effects:**
 - ✓ They cause a variety of health risks that are attributed to PFA exposure, including decreased fertility, developmental effects in children, interference with body hormones, increased cholesterol levels, and increased risk of some cancers.
 - ✓ Recent research has also revealed that long-term low-level exposure to certain PFAs can make it difficult for humans to build antibodies after being vaccinated against various diseases.
 - **What can be done to Remove these Chemicals?**
 - **Incineration:**
 - ✓ The most common method of destroying PFAS is incineration, but most PFAS are remarkably resistant to being burned. That's why they're used in firefighting foams.
 - ✓ PFAS has multiple fluorine atoms attached to a carbon atom, and the bond between carbon and fluorine is one of the strongest.

- ✓ Normally to burn something, you have to break the bond, but fluorine resists breaking off from carbon.
- ✓ Most PFAS will break down completely at incineration temperatures around 1,500 degrees Celsius (2,730 degrees Fahrenheit), but it's energy intensive and suitable incinerators are scarce.
- **Supercritical Water Oxidation:**
 - ✓ Scientists have developed supercritical water oxidation to destroy PFAS.
 - ✓ High temperatures and pressures change the state of water, accelerating chemistry in a way that can destroy hazardous substances.
- **Plasma Reactors:**
 - ✓ Researchers are working with plasma reactors, which use water, electricity, and argon gas to break down PFAS.
- **Filtration System:**
 - ✓ A filtration system can be used with activated carbon in the rainwater harvesting system.
 - ✓ The activated carbon will need to be removed and replaced regularly. Also, the old contaminated material must be destroyed.
 - ✓ There are several other experimental techniques that are promising but haven't been scaled up to treat large amounts of the chemicals.

Q 32.D

- In the early 19th century, the English started to show an interest in **Sindh** where they enjoyed some trade facilities authorised by a **farman of the Mughal Emperor in 1630**. The farman provided the English with such privileges in the ports of Sindh which they enjoyed elsewhere. This advantage was enjoyed by the English upto **1775** when a not-too-friendly ruler, **Sarfraz Khan, made the English close their factory**.
- In June 1807, the alliance of Tilsit with Alexander I of Russia was joined by Napoleon Bonaparte. The alliance had as one of its conditions a combined invasion of India by the land route. Now the **British wanted to create a barrier between Russia and British India**. To achieve this, Lord Minto sent three delegations under the leadership of various prominent persons to forge alliances. Accordingly, Metcalfe was sent to Lahore, Elphinstone to Kabul and Malcolm to Tehran. **Sindh was visited by Nicholas Smith** who met the Amirs to conclude a defensive arrangement. After negotiations, the Amirs agreed to a treaty—their first-ever treaty with the English.
- **In 1843, under Governor-General Ellenborough, Sindh was merged into the British Empire** and Charles Napier was appointed its first governor.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 33.D

- Aravipuram Movement was launched by **Sri Narayana Guru** on Shivaratri day of **1888**. On that day, Sri Narayana Guru **defied the religious restrictions traditionally placed on the Ezhava community** and consecrated **an idol of Shiva** at Aravipuram. In 1888, he installed an idol of Siva at Aravippuram in Kerala in an effort to show that the **consecration of god's image was not a monopoly of the brahmins**.
- **Lord Curzon** succeeded Lord Elgin and served as India's Viceroy between **1899 and 1905**. He became the youngest Viceroy of India at the age of 39.
 - The British Viceroy, Lord Curzon, passed the **Indian Universities Act in 1904** on the **recommendations of the Raleigh Commission**, which tightened control over Indian universities. The Indian Universities Act made the **universities and colleges completely under the Government's control**. The Governor General was now empowered to decide a University's territorial limits and also affiliation between the universities and colleges.
 - The Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI), popularly known as **Pusa Institute, began in 1905 at Pusa (Bihar)** with a generous grant of 30,000 pounds from an American philanthropist, **Henry Phipps**. The Foundation stone of the Institute was laid by the then **Viceroy Lord Curzon** on 1st April 1905. It is India's national Institute for **agricultural research, education, and extension**. The IARI was **responsible for the research leading to the "Green Revolution in India" of the 1970s**.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 34.D

- **Justice Party, officially the South Indian Liberal Federation**, was a political party in the Madras Presidency of British India. The South Indian Liberal Federation (SILF) **was started by T. M. Nair, P. Theagaraya Chetti, and C. Natesa Mudaliar** in 1916 against the domination of brahmins in government service, education and political field. **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**

- It opposed the Congress as a Brahman-dominated organisation and claimed separate communal representation for the non-Brahmans as had been granted to the Muslims in the Morley-Minto reform. This demand, supported by the colonial bureaucracy, was granted in the Montagu-Chelmsford reform of 1919, as it allocated twenty-eight reserved seats to the non-Brahmans in the Madras Legislative Council.
- The party also played a vital role in allowing women to contest elections paving the way for **Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy** to become the first woman legislator in India.
 - The pioneering efforts of Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy saw the **abolition of Devadasi system** when the Justice party was in power.
- In 1938, E. V. Ramaswamy (Periyar) was elected the leader of the Justice party. In 1944, Justice Party along with the Self Respect movement was renamed **Dravidar Kazhagam**.

Q 35.C

- Because of the indefatigable efforts of the reformers, a number of administrative measures were adopted by the government to improve the condition of women.
 - **Abolition of Female Infanticide:** Female infanticide was an inhuman practice afflicting 19th-century Indian society. The **Bengal Regulating Acts of 1795 and 1804** were enacted declaring female infanticide illegal. The abolition of infanticide which appears to have been effective in Bengal did not result in any significant opposition from the public. However, the banning of infanticide in other parts of India does not appear to have been effective, as this practice continued even after its prohibition.
 - ✓ The Female Infanticide Prevention Act 1870 was later enacted which made the killing of girl child punishable throughout British India.
 - **Abolition of Sati:** Influenced by the frontal attack launched by the enlightened Indian reformers led by Raja Rammohan Roy, the government declared the practice of Sati illegal and punishable by criminal courts as culpable homicide. The regulation of 1829 (Regulation XVII, A.D. 1829 of the Bengal Code) was applicable in the first instance to Bengal Presidency alone, but was extended in slightly modified forms to Madras and Bombay Presidencies in 1830.
 - **Widow Remarriage:** It was mainly due to the efforts of Pandit Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (1820-91), the principal of Sanskrit College, Calcutta, that the **Widows' Remarriage Act, 1856**, was passed; it legalized the marriage of widows and declared issues from such marriages as legitimate.
 - **Female Infanticide Prevention Act, 1870:** It was passed that made it **compulsory for parents to register the birth of all babies** and provided for verification of female children for some years after birth, particularly in areas where the custom was resorted to in utmost secrecy.
 - **Controlling Child Marriage:** The Native Marriage Act (or Civil Marriage Act), 1872 signified legislative action in prohibiting child marriage. It had a limited impact as the Act was not applicable to Hindus, Muslims and other recognized faiths.
 - **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 36.C

- The **first session of the Indian National Congress (INC)** was held in **December 1885** in Bombay with seventy two delegates. INC was an assembly for politically-minded individuals who were interested in reform. The majority of the founding members of Congress has been educated or lived in Britain including **Badruddin Tyabji, W. C. Bonnerjee, Surendranath Banerjee, Pherozeshah Mehta**, and the brothers Manomohun and Lalmohan Ghose had all studied in London, and had all fallen under the influence of Dadabhai Naoroji.
- Congress had a British committee based in London, acting as a **lobby group in Britain**, which was **founded in 1889. The British Committee of the Indian National Congress** was made up of British men interested in India and some Indians who were based in London. They sought to organize sympathizers to Congress in Britain, write and distribute Congress annual reports and literature, and raise Congress petitions in Parliament through the Indian Parliamentary Committee, chaired by William Wedderburn. Its purpose was to raise **awareness of Indian issues to the public in Britain**, to whom the Government of India was responsible. **Hence statements 1 is correct.**
- The committee followed the work of **W.C. Bonnerjee and Dadabhoi Naoroji**, who raised India related issues in the British Parliament through the support of radical MPs like Charles Bradlaugh. **William Wedderburn served as the first chairman** and William Digby as secretary. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- The British Committee published the **journal 'India' as an organ** to express the views of the Indian National Congress. The journal was used for some of these purposes and to give an accurate account of events in India to British readers. The influence of its early works resulted in the **Indian Council Act 1892**. India became a weekly subscribed journal, 1898-1921. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 37.B

- Charles Wood prepared a despatch on an educational system for India in 1854. This document, known as the "Magna Carta of English Education in India," was the first comprehensive plan for the spread of education in India.
 - Charles Wood was a British Member of Parliament and a member of the Liberal Party. From 1846 to 1852, he was Chancellor of the Exchequer. Later, he was appointed President of the East India Company's Board of Control. He sent the "Wood's despatch" to Governor-General Lord Dalhousie in 1854.
- **Wood's Despatch - Recommendations**
 - It asked the government of India to assume responsibility for the education of the masses, **thus repudiating the 'downward filtration theory'**, at least on paper. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - For the first time, Wood's Despatch recommended the establishment of a Department of Public Instruction in each of Bengal's five provinces: Bombay, Madras, Punjab, and the North-Western provinces.
 - The expansion of mass education was another major recommendation of the Despatch. Because it was discovered that the common people lacked educational opportunities, much emphasis was placed on increasing the number of primary, middle, and high schools.
 - The establishment of universities in the three Presidency towns of Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras was recommended by the Despatch. The universities were to be modeled after the University of London. **Hence statement 4 is correct.**
 - Departments of Arabic, Sanskrit, and Persian, as well as law and civil engineering, were to be established at the universities. Wood's Despatch advocated for the establishment of a grant-in-aid system in Indian education for private educational institutions.
 - The Wood's Despatch emphasized the importance of teaching English while also emphasizing the importance of teaching Indian languages. It **recommended that school education should be imparted in vernacular language.** **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - The Despatch recommended that the government always **support women's education.**
 - It recommended that teacher training schools be established in each province. Engineering, medicine, and law teachers should be trained in special schools.
 - The Wood's Despatch advocated for the establishment of a nationwide network of graded schools.
 - It advocated for imparting **secular education in educational institutions.** **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 38.C

- Raja Rammohun Roy started India's first Persian newspaper the **Mirat-ul-Akhbar**. An erudite Persian scholar and a tenacious social reformer, he believed in 'searching for the truth through the light of the discussion. The newspaper was first published on 12 April 1822. It was published every week on Fridays. Persian was chosen because it was still recognized in courts, and was seen as a means to reach the intelligentsia, the top policymakers of the country. **Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
- **Amrita Bazar Patrika** was started in 1868 by two brothers, **Sisir Kumar Ghosh and Moti Lal Ghosh**, sons of a wealthy merchant in the Bengal province. **Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**
 - The Patrika was very vocal in its views against government policies that were unfair to the common people.
 - The newspaper was accused of sedition and in an attempt to crack down on the media, Lord Lytton, the then Viceroy of India, promulgated the **Vernacular Press Act, in 1878**. It was majorly targeted against Amrita Bazar Patrika and gave the police the power to confiscate any printed material it deemed objectionable.
 - Amrita Bazar Patrika stopped publishing news in Bengali and became an English newspaper overnight.
- **Founded in 1937 by Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, The Associated Journals Limited is the publisher of newspapers National Herald (English), Qaumi Awaz (Urdu) and Navjivan (Hindi).** The Company launched its daily newspapers, National Herald, in 1938 and Qaumi Awaz in 1945. The newspapers served as the voice of India's Freedom Movement.
 - **Qaumi Awaz is an Urdu-language newspaper and is the sister publication of National Herald, both of which were started by Jawahar Lal Nehru.** **Hence pair 3 is not correctly matched.**

Q 39.C

- In 1934, with the formation of the Congress Socialist Party (CSP), the process of the consolidation of the Left forces received a significant push forward. This consolidation of the Left acted as a spur to the formation of an all-India body to coordinate the kisan movement.

- These radical developments on the peasant front culminated in the formation of the **All India Kisan Sabha (AIKS) at the Lucknow session of the Congress in April 1936, with Sahajanand Saraswati elected as its first president** and N.G. Ranga, the pioneer of the kisan movement in Andhra and a renowned scholar of the agrarian problem, the General Secretary. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The first session was greeted in person by Jawaharlal Nehru. Other participants included Ram Manohar Lohia, Sohan Singh Josh, Indulal Yagnik, Jayaprakash Narayan etc.
- **A Kisan Manifesto was finalized at the All-India Kisan Committee session in Bombay and formally presented to the Congress Working Committee to be incorporated into its forthcoming manifesto for the 1937 elections. The Kisan Manifesto considerably influenced the agrarian programme adopted by the Congress at its Faizpur session,** which included demands for fifty per cent reduction in land revenue and rent, a moratorium on debts, the abolition of feudal levies, security of tenure for tenants, a living wage for agricultural labourers, and the recognition of peasant unions. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- A number of CSP leaders following the 1935 Comintern decision to follow a 'united front' strategy- joined the AIKS and helped in consolidating the movement where it already existed, such as UP, Bihar and Orissa, and also in extending the movement to other provinces, such as Bengal, where a provincial Kisan Sabha was started in March 1937. **It was also because of its CSP members the AIKS remained a part of the Congress and maintained a close relationship with the provincial Congress committees. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 40.C

- **Recently, the Central government has told the Odisha government that its ordinance to bring the 11th-century Lingaraj temple in Bhubaneswar and its associated temples under a special law is outside the legislative competence of the state legislature. It also said the ordinance is in conflict with the rules laid down under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958 (AMASR Act).**
- Lingaraj temple, the largest in **Bhubaneswar, Odisha** was constructed by **King Jajati Keshari in the 10th Century and completed by King Lalatendu Keshari in the 11th Century. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The main spire is 54 metres high. Besides, there is a pillared hall, a dancing hall (NatyaMandap) and a hall for serving offerings (BhogaMandap).The walled campus has about 50 smaller shrines, including one dedicated to Goddess Parvati. It is the biggest temple in Bhubaneswar. This great temple built in red stone represents the quintessence of the Kalinga type of architecture, the culminating result of the architectural activities at Bhubaneswar.
- It does not lie on the banks of river Krishna as river Krishna doesn't flow through Odisha. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- Lingaraj is referred to as 'Swayambhu' – (self-originated Shivling). **Another important aspect of the temple is that it signifies the syncretisation of Shaivism and Vaishnavism sects in Odisha.** The Shivling is known as Hari Hara. Perhaps the rising cult of Lord Jagannath which coincided with the completion of the Lingaraj Temple had a role to play. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 41.A

- **Paramahansa Mandali Founded in 1849 in Maharashtra, the founders of the Paramahansa Mandali—Dadoba Pandurang, Mehtaji Durgaram and others—began as a secret society that worked to reform Hindu religion and society in general. The founders of the mandali were primarily interested in breaking caste rules.** The ideology of the society was closely linked to that of the Manav Dharma Sabha. Besides believing that one god should be worshipped, society also said real religion is based on love and moral conduct. **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- At their meetings, food cooked by lower caste people was taken by the members. This mandali also advocated widow remarriage and women's education. Branches of Paramahansa Mandali existed in Poona, Satara, and other towns of Maharashtra.
- **Mahatma Jyotiba Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj (Truth Seekers' Society) in 1873, with the leadership of the samaj coming from the backward classes, malis, telis, kunbis, saris and dhangars.** This movement gave a sense of identity to the depressed communities as a class against those upper-caste people who used religion and the blind faith of the masses to exploit the masses for personal monetary gain. **Phule aimed at the complete abolition of the caste system and socio-economic inequalities; he was against Sanskrit Hinduism. The samaj rejected the approach of Vedic culture, Upanishads, and the predominance of Aryan society.**

- **Narayan Malhar Joshi** founded the **Social Service League in Bombay** with an aim to secure for the masses better and reasonable conditions of life and work. Joshi also founded the **All India Trade Union Congress (1920)** to organize workers against British policies.
- **Dharma Sabha** was formed in 1830 in Calcutta by **Radhakanta Deb**. The organization was established mainly to counter the ongoing social reform movements led by protagonists such as Raja Ram Mohan Roy and Henry Derozio. **The focus of the association was on the preservation of the status quo in socio-religious matters of Hindu Society against intrusion by the British administration.**

Q 42.D

- The Doctrine of Lapse was an annexation policy followed widely by **Lord Dalhousie** when he was India's **Governor-General from 1848 to 1856**. It was used as an administrative policy for the extension of British Paramountcy.
- **Features of Doctrine of Lapse:**
 - According to this doctrine, any princely state under the direct or indirect (as a vassal) control of the East India Company, should the ruler not produce a legal male heir, would be annexed by the company.
 - As per this, any adopted son of the Indian ruler could not be proclaimed as heir to the kingdom. **The adopted son would only inherit his foster father's personal property and estates.** Dalhousie recognised the right of the adopted son to succeed to the personal property of the Chieftan and for this sanction was not required. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - The adopted son would also **not be entitled to any pension** that his father had been receiving or to any of his father's titles. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - This was **not introduced by Lord Dalhousie** even though it was he who documented it and used it widely to acquire territories for the British. As early as **1834 the Court of Directors** had laid down that in case of failure of lineal successors the permission 'to adopt' was an indulgence that "should be the exception, not the rule, and should not be granted but as a special mark of favour and approbation". Few years later in 1841, the Home authorities decided in favour of a uniform policy. It was in pursuance of the policy thus laid down that Mandavi state was annexed in 1839, Kolaba and Jalaun in 1840 and the titular dignity of the Nawab of Surat abolished in 1842. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Dalhousie's** contribution was that he **uniformly applied this Doctrine** and did not ignore or neglect any opportunity in consolidating the territories of the East India Company.

Q 43.A

- The Cochin Shipyard handed over to the Navy the indigenous aircraft carrier Vikrant, which was designed by the Navy's in-house Directorate of Naval Design.
- **Indigenous aircraft carrier INS Vikrant is named after India's first aircraft carrier, the Indian Naval Ship (INS) Vikrant**, which played a significant role in the 1971 war.
- The 262-metre-long carrier has a full displacement of close to 45,000 tonnes, much larger and advanced than her predecessor.
- **The aircraft carrier is powered by four gas turbines totalling 88 MW power and has a maximum speed of 28 knots. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **With an overall indigenous content of 76 per cent, the aircraft carrier is a perfect example of the quest for Aatma Nirbhar Bharat** and provides a thrust to the government's Make in India initiative, the Navy said. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- With the delivery of Vikrant, India has joined a select group of nations having the niche capability to indigenously design and build an aircraft carrier — such as the United States and China .
- Vikrant has been built with a high degree of automation for machinery operation, ship navigation and survivability, and has been designed to accommodate an assortment of fixed-wing and rotary aircraft.
- The ship would be capable of operating an air wing consisting of 30 aircraft comprising MIG-29K fighter jets, Kamov-31, MH-60R multi-role helicopters, in addition to indigenously manufactured advanced light helicopters and light combat aircraft.
- Using a novel aircraft-operation mode known as STOBAR (Short Take-Off but Arrested Landing), the aircraft carrier is equipped with a ski-jump for launching aircraft, and a set of "arrestor wires" for their recovery onboard.
- The aircraft carrier has a large number of indigenous equipment and machinery from major industrial houses in the country such as BEL, BHEL, GRSE, Keltron, Kirloskar, Larsen & Toubro, Wartsila India etc as well as over 100 micro, small and medium enterprises.
- A major spin-off of this is the production of indigenous warship-grade steel through a partnership between the Navy, DRDO and the Steel Authority of India (SAIL), which has enabled the country to become self-

sufficient with respect to warship steel. Today all the warships being built in the country are being manufactured using indigenous steel, defence officials said.

Q 44.D

- The Indian capitalists' attitude had undergone significant changes on this issue over time. **During the Swadeshi Movement (1905-08), the capitalists remained opposed to the boycott agitation.** Even during the Non-Cooperation Movement of the early 1920s, a small section of the capitalists, including Purshottamdas, openly declared themselves enemies of the Non-Cooperation Movement. **However, during the 1930s Civil Disobedience Movement, the capitalists largely supported the movement and** refused to respond to the Viceroy's exhortations to publicly repudiate the Congress stand and his offer of full guarantee of government protection against any harassment for doing so. **Hence statements 1 and 2 are correct.**
- Indian capitalist class had its own notions of how the anti-imperialist struggle ought to be waged. It was always in favour of not completely abandoning **the constitutional path and the negotiating table and generally preferred to put its weight behind constitutional forms of struggle** as opposed to mass civil disobedience. This was due to several reasons. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - There was the fear that mass civil disobedience, especially if it was prolonged, would unleash forces which could turn the movement revolutionary in a social sense.
 - Capitalists were unwilling to support a prolonged all-out hostility to the government of the day as it prevented the continuing of day-to-day business and threatened the very existence of the class.
- The increasing radicalization of the Congress in the Left direction in the 1930s, with the growing influence of Nehru, and the Socialists and Communists within the Congress, spurred the capitalists into becoming more active in the political field.
 - The fear of radicalization of the national movement, however, did not push the capitalists into the 'lap of imperialism,' as predicted by contemporary radicals and as actually happened in some other colonial and semi-colonial countries. Instead, the Indian capitalists evolved a subtle, many-sided strategy to contain the Left, no part of which involved a sell-out to imperialism or imperial interests.
 - **For example, in 1928, the capitalists refused to support the Government in introducing the Public Safety Bill,** which was intended to contain the Communists, on the ground that such a provision would be used to attack the national movement. **Hence statement 4 is correct.**

Q 45.C

- In March, 1921, **Shri N. M. Joshi, then General Secretary of the All India Trade Union Congress,** successfully moved a resolution in the Central Legislative Assembly recommending that Government should introduce legislation for the registration and protection of trade unions. Opposition from employers to the adoption of such a measure was, however, so great that it was not until 1926 that the Indian Trade Unions Act was passed.
- **The Trade Union Act, 1926**
 - recognized trade unions as legal associations; **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - laid down conditions for registration and regulation of trade union activities;
 - secured immunity, both civil and criminal, for trade unions from prosecution for legitimate activities, but put some restrictions on their political activities. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 46.B

- Babasaheb Ambedkar, who had experienced the worst form of casteist discrimination during his childhood, fought against upper caste tyranny throughout his life. He organised the All India Scheduled Castes Federation, while several other leaders of the depressed classes founded the All India Depressed Classes Association. Ambedkar condemned the hierarchical and insular caste system as a whole, and advocated the annihilation of the institution of caste for the real progress of the nation. The struggle of the depressed classes led to the provision of special representation for these classes in the Government of India Act, 1935.
- **Dr Bhimrao Ambedkar led the Mahad Satyagraha in March 1927 to challenge the regressive customs of the caste Hindus.** He stressed the necessity of removing ideas of 'high' and 'low' and inculcating self-elevation through self-help, self-respect and self-knowledge. He led a procession of some 2,500 'untouchables' through the town of Mahad to the Chawdar tank, a public source of water tank from which the untouchables were not allowed to draw water. Dr Ambedkar took water from the tank and drank it. There were huge protests by caste Hindus. Later in December 1927, Ambedkar and his colleagues burnt the 'Manusmriti' at the same place as a gesture of getting rid of inequalities.
- **Dr Ambedkar established the Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha in 1924 to highlight the difficulties and grievances of the dalits before the government.** Its motto was: 'Educate, Agitate and Organise'.
- **Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 47.A

- The foundation of the Indian National Congress in 1885 was not a sudden event or a historical accident. It was the culmination of a process of political awakening that had its beginning within the 1860s and 1870s and took a serious breakthrough within the late 1870s and early 1880s.
 - It was founded in December 1885 and was the first organized expression of the Indian National Movement on an all-India scale.
- **In the Surat session**, conducted at the banks of river Tapi, Extremists demanded that Lala Lajpat Rai be elected as the president of the Congress. But the Moderates were successful in getting **elected Rash Behari Ghose as the president. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **George Yule** was the first non-Indian President of the Indian National Congress. He presided over the Allahabad session of 1888. Alfred Webb presided over the Madras session of 1894. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 48.C

- A major agrarian outbreak occurred in the Poona and Ahmednagar districts of Maharashtra in 1875. **Here, as part of the Ryotwari system, land revenue was settled directly with the peasant who was also recognized as the owner of his land.** Peasant found it difficult to pay land revenue without getting into the clutches of the moneylender and increasingly losing his land. This led to growing tension between the peasants and the moneylenders most of whom were outsiders — Marwaris or Gujaratis. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Causes of the Deccan riots:**
 - During the early 1860s, the American Civil War had led to a rise in cotton exports which had pushed up prices. The end of the Civil War in 1864 brought about an acute depression in cotton exports and a crash in prices. The ground slipped from under the peasants' feet.
 - Simultaneously, in 1867, 'the Government raised land revenue by nearly 50 per cent.
 - The situation was worsened by a succession of bad harvests.
- **Peasants organized a complete social boycott of the 'outsider' moneylenders to compel them to accept their demands in a peaceful manner.** They refused to buy from their shops. No peasant would cultivate their fields. This social boycott spread rapidly to the villages of Poona, Ahmednagar, Sholapur and Satara districts. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- The social boycott was soon transformed into agrarian riots. Peasants seized and publicly burnt debt bonds and deeds — signed under pressure, in ignorance, or through fraud — decrees, and other documents dealing with their debts. There was very little violence in this settling of accounts.
- **The Deccan disturbances had very limited objectives. There was once again an absence of anti-colonial consciousness.** It was, therefore, possible for the colonial regime to extend them certain protection against the moneylenders through the Deccan Agriculturists' Relief Act of 1879. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 49.A

- The final shape of the idea of an All-Indian organization was given by English Civil Servant, A.O. Hume, who mobilised leading intellectuals of the time. The Congress had been founded by A.O. Hume after consultations with Lord Dufferin. **The first session of the Indian National Congress (INC) was attended by 72 delegates and presided over by Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee.** Hereafter, the Congress met every year in December, in a different part of the country each time.
- **The Calcutta session of 1886** was presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji. In this session, the Indian Association merged with the Indian National Congress. (The Indian National Association was founded by Surendranath Banerjee and Anand Mohan Bose in 1876.). **Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
 - **Allahabad session of 1888, was presided over by George Yule. He was the first non-Indian President of the Indian National Congress.**
- **The Calcutta session, 1896** of INC was held under the presidentship of Rahimtullah Sayani. In this session, **Vande Mataram** was sung for the first time by Rabindranath Tagore. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
 - **Madras session of 1898**, was the 14th session of INC. Ananda Mohan Bose was the Chairman of this session.
- As the President of the Congress, in 1906, **Dadabhai Naoroji laid down the goal of the national movement as "self-government or Swaraj,"** on lines of self-governing colonies (Canada and Australia) of the British Empire. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**
 - To prevent the split within Congress four resolutions on the Swadeshi, Boycott, National Education, and Self-Government demands were passed during the 1906 Calcutta session.

Q 50.A

- **Governor General Lord Lytton (1876-1880)** introduced the **Statutory Civil Service** in the 1870s. It meant that **Indians of ability and merit could be nominated to a few positions** hitherto reserved for the European covenanted civil servants. Accordingly, one-sixth of covenanted posts were to be filled by Indians of high families through nominations by local governments subject to approval by the Secretary of State and the Viceroy.
- The structure of the civil service was again reformed in 1892, on the basis of the recommendations of a Public Service Commission submitted five years ago. The new regulations retained the **exclusive status of the covenanted civil service and called it the Indian Civil Service (ICS)**. The Uncovenanted Civil Service, on the other hand, was to be **called the Provincial Civil Service**. The **Statutory Civil Service was abolished**, and in its place, certain higher positions which were previously preserved for the ICS were now to be filled in through promotion from the Provincial Civil Service.
- In **1893**, the **House of Commons in England** passed a **resolution supporting the holding of simultaneous examinations** in India and England; but the resolution was not implemented. From **1922 onwards** the Indian Civil Service **Examination began to be held in India**.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 51.A

- **A newly identified gene can hold the key to prevent fungal infection Candidiasis that often affects intensive-care unit (ICU) patients, cancer patients and patients receiving immunosuppressive therapy.**
- The gene called CSA6 has been identified in *Candida albicans* a fungal species infamous for causing high rates of morbidity and mortality under certain immuno-compromised conditions such as AIDS or during cancer treatment. The fungal species residing in mucosal linings of the gastrointestinal and urogenital tract of healthy individuals turns into a pathogen under immuno-compromised conditions breaching the host defense causing superficial as well as life-threatening systemic infection.
- In a recent collaborative study between Professor Kaustuv Sanyal's group at Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research (JNCASR), Bangalore, India and Christophe d'Enfert's group at Institut Pasteur, Paris, France (Jaitly et al, 2022), authors carried out a large-scale screen to identify regulators of chromosome stability in *C. albicans*, a clinically relevant fungal model system. The study published in the journal Nature Communications represents the first-ever report of such an extensive screen in the human fungal pathogen *C. albicans*.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 52.D

- Rural indebtedness and large-scale alienation of agricultural land to non-cultivating classes was a countrywide phenomenon in rural India during the last quarter of the 19th century. Faced with peasant uprisings in Bengal and Maharashtra the Government could not wait for a similar rebellion in Punjab before it would act. The communal complexion of the Punjab rural situation and the martial character of the Sikhs called for early effective action.
 - Following its annexation by the British in 1847, Punjab province witnessed several significant developments—individualization of property rights in land, fixation and rigorous collection of land revenue in cash, the introduction of a new legal-administrative system, construction of a road and railway network, canal-building activities and a colonization program, commercialization of agriculture and increased monetization of economic transactions.
 - These developments created a situation which, in turn, gave rise to two related problems –agricultural indebtedness and land transfer.
- As early as 1895 the Government addressed a circular to the provincial governments suggesting the advisability of imposing restrictions on the alienation of agricultural land. The famines of 1896-97 and 1899-1900 resulted in large-scale distress and brought the matter into sharp focus. **The Punjab Land Alienation Act, 1900 was passed "as an experimental measure " to be extended to the rest of the country if it worked successfully in Punjab.**
 - The Act divided the Punjab population under three heads viz., the agricultural classes, the statutory agriculturist class (those who though not belonging to the agricultural class long settled interests in the land) and the rest of the population including the moneylenders.
 - Restrictions were imposed on the sale and mortgage of the land from the first category to the other two categories, though members of the second and third category could sell or mortgage land as they pleased.

- The Punjab peasant was also given partial relief against the oppressive incidence of land revenue demand by the Government whereby the state land revenue demand was not to exceed 50% of the annual rental value of the land.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 53.B

- On **16th October 1905**, Bengal was partitioned by **Curzon** on the pretext of it being too big to administer. Instead of dividing it on the basis of non-Bengali areas, the division was on the basis of Hindus and Muslims. British thought that by partitioning, they would succeed in dividing Hindu politicians of West and East Bengal and increase Hindu-Muslim tensions. A movement was launched under the moderates. **Swadeshi and Swaraj** became the slogan of the common man and the whole of India was drawn into the National movement.
- The Indian National Congress, meeting in **1905 under the presidentship of G.K. Gokhale**, resolved to condemn the partition of Bengal and the reactionary policies of Curzon, and support the anti-partition and **Swadeshi Movement of Bengal**.
- **Stand of Muslims:** A group of **educated liberal Muslims** came forward and tendered support to the anti-partition agitation and the Swadeshi Movement. This broad-minded group supported the Indian National Congress and opposed the partition. The most prominent among this section of the Muslims were:
 - **Khwaja Atiqullah**, step-brother of Nawab Salimullah. At the **Calcutta session of the Congress (1906)**, he moved a resolution denouncing the partition of Bengal.
 - **Abdur Rasul**, a prominent muslim leader. He presided over the **Bengal Congress Conference** held at Barisal in 1906. He published the Weekly **Mussalman** in 1906.
 - **Liaquat Hussain**, a liberal Muslim who vehemently opposed the 'Divide and Rule' policy of the British.
- Most of the upper and middle class Muslims stayed away or, led by **Nawab Khwaja Salimullah of Dacca**, **supported the partition** on the plea that it would give them a Muslim-majority East Bengal. To further government interests, the All India Muslim League was propped up on December 30, 1905 as an anti-Congress front, and reactionary elements like Nawab Salimullah of Dacca were encouraged.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 54.B

- Recently the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) celebrated its Silver Jubilee.
- **National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA):** NPPA was set up as an independent Regulator on 29th August 1997 for the pricing of drugs and to ensure the availability and accessibility of medicines at affordable prices. **NPPA is neither a Statutory nor a Constitutional Body.**
- It is an **attached office of the Department of Pharmaceuticals (DoP), Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers** was created vide the Government of India Resolution published in the Gazette of India. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Functions of NPPA include:**
 - **Fixation and revision of prices of Scheduled drugs under Drug (Price Control) Order** issued from time to time. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - **Monitoring and enforcement of prices.**
 - Ensuring availability and accessibility of all medicines and medical devices, including nonscheduled drugs.
 - To undertake and/or sponsor relevant studies in respect of the pricing of drugs/formulations.
 - To collect/maintain data on production, exports, and imports, market share of individual companies, the profitability of companies, etc. for bulk drugs and formulations.
 - To deal with all legal matters arising out of the decisions of the Authority.
 - To render advice to the Central Government on changes/revisions in the drug policy.

Q 55.C

- The phase of economic exploitation of India between the closing decades of the nineteenth century till 1947 has been termed the Period of Finance Capital. During this phase, the Capital inflow became another instrument of Indian exploitation.
- There was no investment of British capital in India till 1833 i.e., throughout the period the Company traded. **The flow of British capital into India became significant only after 1857** and penetrated into diverse economic fields in the latter half of the 19th century but tightened its tentacles over India in the 20th century in the form of finance capital. Thus, **there was a capital flow though not significant prior to the**

revolt of 1857. For example, the first railway line was laid from **Bombay to Thane in 1853** with the help of the British capital. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**

- **British capital investment in India normally took two basic forms:**
 - **Loans were raised in England by the Secretary of State** on behalf of the Indian Government and by semi-public organisations mostly for investment in railways, irrigation, developments of ports, and hydro-electric projects.
 - Foreign business investments in India.
- In 1849, the colonial state of India entered an agreement with the Great Indian Peninsular Railway Company and the East India Railway Company to construct the railway from Bombay to Thane and from Howrah to Raniganj coal fields. These experimental agreements were then extended to other companies to develop railways in other parts of the country. They **were given a state guarantee of a minimum return of 5% on their paid-up capital.** **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 56.D

- The Pitt's India Act, 1784 also called the East India Company Act, 1784 was passed by the British Parliament to correct the defects of the Regulating Act of 1773.
- **Provisions:**
 - This act resulted in dual control of British possessions in India by the British government and the Company with the final authority resting with the government.
 - **A Board of Control consisting of six members was constituted** to take care of civil and military affairs, and would include one of the Secretary of State (Board President), the chancellor of the exchequer and four privy councillors. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - The Governor-General's council's **strength was reduced to three from four members.** One of the three would be the Commander-in-Chief of the British Crown's army in India. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - The **orders** of the board became **binding on the Court of Directors**, which was required to send all its letters and dispatches to the board for its perusal. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 57.B

- The Chuars were adivasis (indigenous people) who lived in the Jungle Mahals. During the early period of colonial rule, the Jungle Mahal extended from Midnapore to Ranchi, Bankura and parts of Purulia and Birbhum district. The Chuars offered stiff resistance to the colonial rulers from the 1770s.
- **Chuar rebellion or Chuar revolt, also known as the Jungle Mahal movement was a series of peasant movements between 1771 to 1809** by the tribal inhabitants of the countryside surrounding the Jungle Mahals settlements of Midnapore, Bankura and Manbhum against the rule of the East India Company (EIC). **Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.**
 - The introduction of a farming system in the Jungle Mahals brought misfortune to the traditional Zamindars of that region. The Company was also trying to establish its monopoly over the production of salt and as a result the Nimki Mahals too. The rebels rose in revolt in response to the East India Company's oppressive land revenue policy, which endangered their economic survival leading to the Chuar rebellion.
- The most significant uprising was under Durjan (or Durjol) Singh in 1798. Durjan Singh was the zamindar of Raipur from which he was dispossessed owing to the operations of Bengal Regulations. In May 1798, his followers, a body of 1,500 Chuars, indulged in violent activities in Raipur to halt the auction of the estate of Raipur. The revolt was brutally suppressed by the British.

Q 58.B

- Tribal movements under British rule were the most frequent, militant, and violent of all movements. The land settlements of the British affected the joint ownership tradition among the tribals and disrupted their social fabric.
- The cause of the tribal violence was directed towards the money-lenders and traders who were seen as extensions of the colonial government. **As agriculture was extended in a settled form by the Company government, the tribals lost their land, and there was an influx of non-tribals to these areas due to colonial revenue policies. The money lenders introduced in the tribal areas led to severe exploitation of the local tribals. They became bonded labourers under the new economic system. The tribal societies had a system of joint ownership of land which was replaced by the notion of private property.** **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**

- Another common cause was the resentment against the imposition of laws by the 'foreign government' that was seen as an effort at destroying the tribal's traditional socio-economic framework. **The Indian Forest Act of 1865 extended British colonialism's claim over forests in India.**
 - **Its main aim was an assertion of the monopoly of the British over the Indian forest land, and it gave the government undisputable power to regulate the forest and pastures. It enabled the Revenue and Forest Department to control the entire forest and grazing land.** Some forests were classified as Reserved Forests for they produced timber that the British wanted. In these forests, people were not allowed to move freely, practice jhum cultivation, collect fruits, or hunt animals. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- **The Begar system of forced labour was introduced in tribal areas as well that had altered labour relations. An influx of Christian Missionaries was supported by the British.** The reason behind intense tribal rebellion is that zamindars, the Police, the revenue, and the court alas have exercised a combined system of extortions, oppressive exactions, forcible dispossession of property, abuse, and personal violence, and a variety of petty tyrannies upon the tribals. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- Under British rule, the functions and powers of the tribal chiefs changed considerably. **They were allowed to keep their land titles over a cluster of villages and rent out lands as zamindars but they lost much of their administrative power and were forced to follow laws made by British officials in India.**
 - **They also had to pay tribute to the British, and discipline the tribal groups on behalf of the British. They lost the authority they had earlier enjoyed amongst their people and were unable to fulfill their traditional functions.**
- **All these reasons compelled tribals to rise against the British rulers.**

Q 59.C

- **A full-court meeting:** A full court meeting literally means one which is attended by all the judges of the court. There are no written rules dealing with this. **Hence statement 1 is correct and statement 2 is not correct.**
- The roots of the custom lie in the 'en banc session, which is a meeting in which a case is heard before all judges of the court. The term 'en banc' review was often used for complex cases with far-reaching ramifications. In some countries, en banc hearing is common and not an exception. The Supreme Court of the United States, and the highest courts of most countries, do not sit in panels, but judges hear the cases 'en banc' unless a judge opts out due to ill health or recusal.
- **As per convention, a full court meeting is convened at the discretion of the Chief Justice of India, it does not follow any particular calendar. It is called to discuss issues of importance to the judiciary. Hence statement 3 is not correct.** The senior designations of practicing advocates in the Supreme Court and high courts are also decided during the full court meetings.
- Full court meetings have been held many times in the past. In March 2020, it was convened to discuss demands by associations of lawyers to close the court till further notice following the Covid-10 outbreak and its subsequent spread among court staff and to decide the further steps to be taken. Also, a full court meeting held on May 7, 1997, decided that "every Judge should make a declaration of all his/her assets in the form of real estate or investment".
- **Significance:** The basic idea is to take everyone along. Full court meetings are an ideal occasion to arrive at common solutions to deal with problems that beset the country's legal system and to make any amends, if necessary, in the administrative practices of the court.

Q 60.D

- The Sanyasis rose in rebellion after the great famine of 1770 in Bengal which caused acute chaos and misery. The Bengal famine of 1770 led peasants whose lands were confiscated, displaced zamindars, and disbanded soldiers, and poor to come together in a rebellion. They were joined by the Sanyasis (who were originally peasants) and Fakirs.
- However, the immediate cause of the rebellion was the restrictions imposed by the British upon pilgrims visiting holy places among both Hindus and Muslims. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Two famous Hindu leaders who supported them were Bhawani Pathak and a woman, Devi Choudhurani.** They attacked English factories and seized their goods, cash, arms and ammunition. Maznoom Shah was one of their prominent leaders.
 - It was only after a prolonged action that **Lord Warren Hastings** (Governor-General of Bengal) could subdue the sanyasis. Equal participation of Hindus and Muslims characterized the uprisings. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

- **Anandamath, a semi-historical novel by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, is based on the Sanyasi Revolt.** Bankim Chandra also wrote a novel, *Devi Chaudhurani*, as he saw the importance of women too taking up the struggle against an alien rule that posed a threat to traditional Indian values. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 61.C

- In the early nineteenth century, increased Russian influence in Persia replaced British influence and thwarted an English scheme for the establishment of a new route by River Euphrates to India. Especially after the Treaty of Turkomanchai (1828), the English got alarmed about possible Russian plans regarding India. Soon, there was a search for a scientific frontier from the Indian side. Passes of the north-west seemed to hold the key to enter India. The need was felt for Afghanistan to be under the control of a ruler friendly to the British.
- **Lord Auckland** who came to India as the governor-general in 1836, **advocated a forward policy.**
 - This implied that the Company government in India itself had to take initiatives to protect the boundary of British India from a probable Russian attack.
 - This objective was to be achieved either through treaties with the neighbouring countries or by annexing them completely. This prompted the British government to go ahead with the forward policy, and Tripartite Treaty (1838) was entered into by the British, Sikhs and Shah Shuja (who had been deposed from the Afghan throne in 1809 and had been living since then as a British pensioner at Ludhiana).
- **John Lawrence (1864-1869) started a policy of masterly inactivity** which was a reaction to the disasters of the First Afghan War and an outcome of practical common sense and intimate knowledge of the frontier problem and of Afghan passion for independence.
- **Lord Lytton** started a new foreign policy of 'proud reserve', which was aimed at having scientific frontiers and safeguarding 'spheres of influence'. According to Lytton, the relations with Afghanistan could no longer be left ambiguous. **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**
- Lytton made an offer of a favourable treaty to Sher Ali, but the Amir wanted friendship with both his powerful neighbours, Russia and British India, while keeping both of them at arm's length. Later, Sher Ali refused to keep a British envoy in Kabul while having earlier granted a similar concession to the Russians.
 - Lytton was displeased, and when the Russians withdrew their envoy from Kabul, Lytton decided to invade Afghanistan.
 - Sher Ali fled in face of the British invasion, and the **Treaty of Gandamak (May 1879) was signed with Yakub Khan**, the eldest son of Sher Ali.
 - **Treaty of Gandamak (May 1879): The treaty signed after the Second-Anglo Afghan War provided that:**
 - ✓ the Amir conduct his foreign policy with the advice of the Government of India;
 - ✓ a permanent British resident be stationed at Kabul; and
 - ✓ the Government of India gives Amir all support against foreign aggression and an annual subsidy.
- **Under Lord Curzon**, the frontier policy was revised and a new system came into operation. **He followed a realistic and common sense' policy towards the tribesmen.** He would have nothing to do with the 'elastic and pliable adjectives' of Masterly Inactivity or Forward Policy or surrender to the "paralysing influence of these labels. He said: "Let our new frontier policy be called by any name that men choose. Only let it be based not upon obsolete political formulas, but upon up-to-date common sense."
 - In the light of past experience, Curzon hoped "to draft a code of frontier policy which could with consistency, and without violent interruptions, be applied to the whole line of North-Western frontier from the Pamirs to Baluchistan." Curzon's policy may be summed up as a policy of 'military concentration as against diffusion, and of tribal conciliation in place of exasperation'.

Q 62.B

- As the knowledge grew of the high profits earned by the Portuguese in Eastern trade, English traders too wanted a share. So, in 1599, a group of English merchants calling themselves the 'Merchant Adventurers' formed a company. On December 31, 1600, Queen Elizabeth I issued a charter with rights of exclusive trading to the company named the 'Governor and Company of Merchants of London trading into the East Indies'. Initially, a monopoly of 15 years was granted.
- Captain Hawkins arrived in the court of Jahangir in April 1609 itself. But the mission to establish a factory at Surat did not succeed due to opposition from the Portuguese, and Hawkins left Agra in November 1611. In 1611, the English had started trading at Masulipatnam on the south-eastern coast of India and later established a factory there in 1616.

- It was in 1612 that Captain Thomas Best defeated the Portuguese in the sea off Surat; an impressed **Jahangir granted permission to the English in early 1613 to establish a factory at Surat under Thomas Aldworth.**
- **In 1615, Sir Thomas Roe came as an accredited ambassador of James I to the court of Jahangir, staying on there till February 1619.** Though he was unsuccessful in concluding a commercial treaty with the Mughal emperor, he was able to secure a number of privileges, including permission to set up **factories at Agra, Ahmedabad, and Broach.**
- **In 1632, The Company got the golden Farman from the Sultan of Golconda, ensuring their trade's safety and prosperity.**
- **Other important events in the formative years of the company are**
 - 1609 : William Hawkins arrives at Jahangir's court.
 - 1616 : The Company establishes its first factory in the south in Masulipatnam.
 - 1639 : The Company gets the lease of Madras from a local king.
 - 1651 : The Company is given permission to trade at Hooghly (Bengal).
 - 1662 : The British King, Charles II, is given Bombay as dowry for marrying a Portuguese princess (Catherine of Braganza).
 - 1667 : Aurangzeb gives the English a Farman for trade in Bengal.
 - 1691 : The Company gets the imperial order to continue their trade in Bengal in lieu of payment of Rs 3,000 a year.
 - 1717 : The Mughal emperor Farrukhsiyar issues a Farman, called the Magna Carta of the Company, giving the Company a large number of trade concessions.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 63.A

- The **Fowler Committee** was appointed by the **British government in 1898 to reform the Indian Currency system.**
- Until 1892, silver was the metal on which Indian currency and coinage had largely been based. The Fowler Committee recommended the continuance of the Indian Government proposals made in 1892 and implemented in 1893. It concurred with the Government of India in its decision not to revert to the silver standard. It further **recommended establishing a gold currency**, making the sovereign legal tender. Also recommended was opening the Indian mints to the unrestricted coinage of gold, receiving gold and reissuing them as coins. The exchange rate for gold was to be fixed at 15 rupees to the sovereign or is. 4d. per rupee (one shilling and four pence), as originally contemplated in 1893. **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- **In 1926 the Royal Commission on Indian Currency (Hilton Young Commission)** recommended the establishment of a central bank to be called the '**Reserve Bank of India**'.

Q 64.B

- The 193-member General Assembly adopted the resolution, which recognises the right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment as a human right, with 161 votes in favour and abstentions by Belarus, Cambodia, China, Ethiopia, Iran, Kyrgyzstan, Russia and Syria.
- While India voted in favour of the resolution, it voiced its concerns over the procedure and substance of the resolution.
- **The resolution recognises the right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment as a human right and "affirms that the promotion of the human right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment requires the full implementation of the multilateral environmental agreements under the principles of international environmental law.**
- India stands ready to support any effort for a better environment and to further international cooperation for environmental protection. In this context, India voted in favour of this resolution, Counsellor in India's Permanent Mission to the UN Ashish Sharma said, delivering the explanation of the vote in the UNGA.
- India has voted in favour of a UN General Assembly resolution that recognises the right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment as a human right, but dissociated itself from an operative paragraph of the text and voiced its concerns over the procedure and substance of the resolution.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 65.D

- Lord Metcalfe was the Governor-General of India from 1835-36. He repealed the obnoxious 1823 ordinance by introducing a new press act (1835) and earned the epithet, "liberator of the Indian press".
 - Earlier, according to the Licensing Regulations, 1823 starting or using a press without a license was a penal offense. Later on, it was extended to cover journals, pamphlets and books.

- These restrictions were directed chiefly against Indian-language newspapers or those edited by Indians. Rammohan Roy's Mirat-ul-Akbar had to stop publication.
- The New Press Act (1835) required a printer/publisher to give a precise account of the premises of a publication and cease functioning, if required by a similar declaration. The result of a liberal press policy was a rapid growth of newspapers. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 66.A

- **Recently the food delivery start-up Swiggy recently announced an “industry-first” policy of allowing its employees to take up gigs or projects outside of their regular employment at the company, during the hours away from work.**
- **What is Moonlighting?** Moonlighting simply refers to the act of having a second job, or working for extra projects, gigs, or employers, that counts as a secondary source of income, outside one's working hours. **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- **Arguments For Moonlighting:**
 - Moonlighting allows workers to work for side projects once they finish their shift timings, without compromising on their primary employment.
 - Gaining extra profits while also helping them hone their skills.
 - Personal choice: After the company's shift timings, a person is free to do whatever he/she wants to do as a passion project or side gig.
 - Build a good profile: Many universities abroad consider such side projects as valuable for admission into professional courses.
- **Arguments Against Moonlighting:**
 - An employee is required and expected to give his entire working time, effort, and energy to the employer's interest.
 - Legal but may not be ethical: There is no overarching law that prohibits a person from doing multiple jobs. However, a person with a similar nature of jobs may spark breach of confidentiality issues.
 - Not legal in some states: There restriction is on double employment under the Factories Act, but not applicable to IT companies in some states.
 - Moonlighting turns to daylight: Side jobs may take away the employee's productivity. Fear of leakage of confidential information of the primary job.

Q 67.D

- **Lord William Bentinck was Governor-General of India from 1828 to 1835.** During his tenure of seven years as the Governor-General of India, many reforms were introduced by him in the field of finance, education, and social reforms.
- He is credited with significant **social and educational reforms in India**, including the abolition of sati and the prohibition of women from witnessing cremations on Varanasi's ghats, as well as the suppression of female infanticide and human sacrifice. There was little opposition to Bentinck's Bengal Sati Regulation, 1829, which he passed after consulting with the army and officials. The most admirable measure taken by Bentinck, which contributed to the material well-being of the people, was the suppression of the 'thugs.'
- He, along with Thomas Babington Macaulay, pioneered the use of English as a language of instruction in India. **English was made the official language of India under his tenure in 1835.**
 - The famous Lord Macaulay's Minute settled the row in favour of Anglicists—the limited government resources were to be devoted to the teaching of Western sciences and literature through the medium of the English language alone.
 - Lord Macaulay held the view that “Indian learning was inferior to European learning”—which was true as far as physical and social sciences in the contemporary stage were concerned.
 - The government soon made English as the medium of instruction in its schools and colleges and opened a few English schools and colleges instead of a large number of elementary schools, thus neglecting mass education.
- Lord Cornwallis had set up four Circuit Courts as provincial courts of appeal. **But, Lord Bentinck abolished four Circuit Courts** and their functions were transferred to collectors under the supervision of the commissioner of revenue and circuit.
 - Sadar Diwani Adalat and Sadar Nizamat Adalat were set up at Allahabad for the convenience of the people of the upper Provinces. Abolition of the provincial courts of appeal and circuit setup by Cornwallis, the appointment of commissioners of revenue and circuit.
- During his tenure annexation of Mysore, Coorg, and Central Cachar happened. **The Treaty of Roopnagar** was signed with Maharaja Ranjit Singh in 1809.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 68.B

- The education imparted in 18th-century India was still traditional which could not match with the rapid developments in the West. The knowledge was confined to literature, law, religion, philosophy, and logic and excluded the study of physical and natural sciences, technology and geography.
- Elementary education among the Hindus and the Muslims was quite widespread. The Hindu and Muslim **elementary schools** were called **pathshalas and makhtabs** respectively. The education was confined to reading, writing, and arithmetic. Children from the lower caste sometimes attended the schools, but female presence was rare.
- **Chatuspathis or Tols**, as they were called in Bihar and Bengal, were the **centres of higher education**. Some of the famous centres for Sanskrit education were **Kasi** (Varanasi), **Tirhut** (Mithila), **Nadia** and **Utkala**. Hence option (b) is the correct answer.
- **Madrasahs** were the institutions of **higher learning for Persian and Arabic**, Persian being the court language and learnt by the Muslims as well as the Hindus. **Azimabad (Patna)** was a famous centre for Persian education.

Q 69.A

- **Kutch branch canal was recently inaugurated:** It is a 357.18-kilometer-long that stretches from the Sardar Sarovar Narmada Dam in Narmada district 750 kilometers away, to the last of the villages of Gujarat's Mandvi taluka, Mod Kuba. A branch canal takes off from the main canals at regular intervals. These canals supply water to major and minor tributary canals.
 - **What is the importance of this project?**
 - ✓ The Saurashtra and North Gujarat regions have been receiving Narmada waters through the Saurashtra Branch Canal, its six sub-branch canals as well as through the canal network in north Gujarat.
 - ✓ **The KBC, which offtakes from the Narmada Main Canal (NMC) at Salimnagar in Kankrej taluka of Banaskantha district**, was delayed because of the many engineering challenges faced while constructing on the terrain of the Rann of Kutch and land acquisition of about 115 hectares, which was pending in Anjar, Gandhidham, Mandvi and Mundra talukas covering a total of 13.860 km. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - ✓ Some sub-canals of Kutch have been operational since 2017 but for areas like Mundra and Mandvi, the KBC will provide water for irrigation to 182 villages. It will also provide drinking water in all 948 villages and 10 towns of the Kutch district.
 - ✓ Now, the KBC is ready to carry water in its entire length, covering 733 km from Sardar Sarovar Dam in Kevadia (now Ektanagar) in Narmada District where the Statue of Unity is located, to Mod kuba. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - ✓ It is acclaimed as the longest branch canal in the world.

Q 70.C

- **Pair 1 is not correctly matched:** The practice of Sati was prevalent in India from ancient times. Bentinck was greatly distressed when he received a report of 800 cases of Sati in a single year and that from Bengal. He determined to abolish this practice which he considered an offence against natural justice. Therefore, he became a crusader against it and promulgated his Regulation XVII on 4 December 1829 prohibiting the practice of Sati. Those who practiced Sati were made liable for punishment by law courts as accessories to the crime. The Regulation was extended to the Madras and Bombay Presidencies in 1830.
- **Pair 2 is not correctly matched:** Lord Ripon is known to have granted the Indians first taste of freedom by introducing the Local Self Government in 1882. His scheme of local self-government developed the Municipal institutions which had been growing up in the country ever since India was occupied by the British Crown.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Lord Hardinge I was the Governor General of India from 1844 to 1848. Following the footsteps of Lord William Bentinck, he suppressed Sati, and infanticide. **He also suppressed the practice of human sacrifice among the Gonds tribe in Central India.**

Q 71.D

- The establishment of British rule in South and South Western India brought new problems of land settlement. **While framing land revenue policies for these areas British officials believed that in these regions, there were no Zamindars with large estates with whom settlement of land revenue could be made and the introduction of the zamindari system would upset the existing state of affairs. Hence statement 1 is correct.**

- Many Madras officials led by Reed and Thomas Munro recommended that settlement should therefore be made directly with actual cultivators.
- They also pointed out that **under the Permanent settlement the Company was a financial loser as it had to share the revenues with the zamindars and could not claim a share of the growing income from land. Moreover, the cultivator was left at the mercy of the zamindar who could oppress him at will. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- **Munro claimed that it is the system that has always prevailed in India. The supporters of the Ryotwari system also claimed that it was a continuation of the state of affairs that had existed in the past.** Due to these factors, Munro introduced the Ryotwari system in the parts of Bombay and Madras presidency in the beginning of the 19th Century. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 72.D

- **The European Investment Bank (EIB), the bank of the European Union, has joined the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI), a partnership of national governments, UN agencies, multilateral development banks and the private sector, which promotes the rapid development of infrastructure resilient to climate change and natural disasters in countries at all stages of development.**
- **Launched at the UN Climate Action Summit in 2019 at the initiative of the Prime Minister of India Shri Narendra Modi, CDRI allows its members to share knowledge and resources and help countries to meet the UN Sustainable Development Goals' (SDGs) and expand universal access to basic services, enabling prosperity and creating decent working conditions. These are all key preconditions for the sustainable development of the global economy. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **CDRI headquarters at New Delhi, India. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- **CDRI membership supports the implementation of the EIB Adaptation Plan, announced at COP26 in Glasgow. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The EIB stands ready to work with CDRI members to unlock the benefits of EU initiatives aiming to achieve sustainable global connectivity, such as the Global Gateway, and climate action initiatives such as the EU Green Deal.
- **EIB membership of CDRI will facilitate faster knowledge sharing, establishment of standards and certification.**
- As the EU climate bank, the EIB will work within CDRI on sharing knowledge, including via its newly deployed development branch, EIB Global. The EU bank will also focus on developing standards and certification relevant to disaster-resilient infrastructure.

Q 73.B

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched: The Women's Indian Association (WIA) was founded at Adayar, Madras, in 1917 by Annie Besant, Margaret Cousins, Jeena Raja Dasa, and others to liberate women from the deplorable condition women suffered in socio-economic and political matters during the 19th and the early 20th century. . The WIA was one of the first organizations to boldly connect Indian women's social and sexual subjugation with patriarchy, poverty, and political disenfranchisement.**
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched: In 1910, Sarla Devi Chaudhurani convened the first meeting of the Bharat Stree Mahamandal in Allahabad. Considered as the first major Indian women's organisation set up by a woman, its objectives included the promotion of education for women, abolition of the purdah system and improvement in the socio-economic and political status of women all over India. Sarla Devi believed that the man working for women's upliftment lived 'under the shade of Manu'.**
- **Pair 3 is not correctly matched: Pandita Ramabai Saraswati (1858-1922), founded the Arya Mahila Samaj to serve the cause of women.** She pleaded for improvement in the educational syllabus of Indian women before the English Education Commission which was referred to Queen Victoria. This resulted in medical education for women which started in Lady Dufferin College. Later Ramabai Ranade established a branch of Arya Mahila Samaj in Bombay.
 - **Ramabai Ranade (1863-1924)** founded the Ladies Social Conference (Bharat Mahila Parishad), under the parent organisation National Social Conference, in 1904 in Bombay. She married Justice Mahadev Govind Ranade and at the age of 18, she joined the Prarthana Samaj founded by her husband — a liberal hub for 19th-century Maharashtra. In 1909, Ramabai Ranade founded **Seva Sadan Society**.

Q 74.A

- Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (1820-1891) was one of the pillars of Bengal renaissance who managed to continue the social reforms movement that was started by Raja Rammohan Roy in the early 1800s. He was a great scholar and reformer, his ideas were a happy blend of Indian and Western thought.

- In 1841, at the age of twenty-one, Ishwar Chandra joined Fort William College as the Head Pandit in the Sanskrit department. The brilliant mind that he was, he soon became proficient in English and Hindi. After five years, in 1846, Vidyasagar left Fort William College and joined Sanskrit College as 'Assistant Secretary'.
- He was determined to break the priestly monopoly of scriptural knowledge, and for this, **he opened the Sanskrit College to non-brahmins. He introduced Western thought in Sanskrit College to break the self-imposed isolation of Sanskrit learning.**
- Vidyasagar started a movement in support of widow remarriage which resulted in the legalization of widow remarriage. He was also a crusader against child marriage and polygamy. He did much for the cause of women's education. As government inspector of schools, he helped organize thirty-five girls' schools many of which he ran at his own expense. **As secretary of Bethune School (established in 1849), he was one of the pioneers of higher education for women in India.**
- **He wrote books 'Upakramonika' and 'Byakaran Koumudi',** interpreting complex notions of Sanskrit grammar in easy legible Bengali language.
- He disseminated his ideals through regular articles he wrote for periodicals and newspapers. **He was associated with prestigious journalistic publications like 'Tattwabodhini Patrika', 'Somprakash', 'Sarbashubhankari Patrika' and 'Hindu Patriot'.**
- He challenged the Brahminical authorities and proved that widow remarriage is sanctioned by Vedic scriptures. He took his arguments to the British Authorities and his pleas were heard when the Hindu Widows Remarriage Act, 1856 or Act XV, 1856, was decreed on July 26, 1856.
 - He did not just stop there. He initiated several matches for the child or adolescent widows within respectable families and even married his son Narayan Chandra to an adolescent widow in 1870 to set an example.
- **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 75.A

- Finnish Meteorological Institute researchers published their study in the Communications Earth & Environment journal, concluding that the **Arctic is heating four times faster than the rest of the planet.** The warming is more concentrated in the Eurasian part of the Arctic, where the Barents Sea north of Russia and Norway is warming at an alarming rate — seven times faster than the global average.
- Arctic amplification
- Global warming, the long-term heating of the earth's surface, expedited due to anthropogenic forces or human activities since pre-industrial times and has increased the planet's average temperature by 1.1 degrees Celsius.
- **While changes are witnessed across the planet, any change in the surface air temperature and the net radiation balance tend to produce larger changes at the north and south poles. This phenomenon is known as polar amplification; these changes are more pronounced at the northern latitudes and are known as the Arctic amplification. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- Among the many global warming-driven causes for this amplification, the ice-albedo feedback, lapse rate feedback, water vapour feedback and ocean heat transport are the primary causes. Sea ice and snow have high albedo (measure of reflectivity of the surface), implying that they are capable of reflecting most of the solar radiation as opposed to water and land. In the Arctic's case, global warming is resulting in diminishing sea ice.
- As the sea ice melts, the Arctic Ocean will be more capable of absorbing solar radiation, thereby driving the amplification. The lapse rate or the rate at which the temperature drops with elevation decreases with warming.
- Studies show that the ice-albedo feedback and the lapse rate feedback are responsible for 40% and 15% of polar amplification respectively.

Q 76.A

- **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Jyotiba Phule (1827-1890), born in Satara, Maharashtra, belonged to the mali (gardener) community and organised a powerful movement against upper caste domination and brahminical supremacy. **Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj (Truth Seekers' Society) in 1873,** with the leadership of the samaj coming from the backward classes. The main aims of the movement were (i) social service, and (ii) the spread of education among women and lower caste people.
- **Pair 2 is not correctly matched:** In order to better organize the campaign for the amelioration of the untouchables' condition, Gandhi set up a new body in October 1932. The All India Anti-Untouchability League was first named and later renamed the Harijan Sevak Sangh. Gandhi started publishing a weekly journal called "Harijan" on 11 February 1933 from Yerwada Jail during British rule.

- **Pair 3 is not correctly matched:** All India Scheduled Castes Federation (SCF), was the first all-India political party exclusively for Scheduled Castes. **Dr. Ambedkar founded SCF in a national convention of the Scheduled castes held at Nagpur.** It was presided by Rao Bahadur N. Shivraj, a renowned Dalit leader from Madras. An executive body of All India SCF was elected in the convention. Rao Bahadur N. Shivraj was elected president and P.N.Rajbhoj (Bombay) was elected general secretary.

Q 77.A

- **The Chess Olympiad is a biennial chess tournament in which teams representing nations of the world compete.** FIDE organises the tournament and selects the host nation. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **The 44th Chess Olympiad (also known as the Chennai Chess Olympiad) is comprising open and women's tournaments,** as well as several events designed to promote the game of chess, is being held in Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India from 28 July to 10 August 2022.
- This is the first Chess Olympiad to take place in India.
- The total number of participants is 1,736, with 937 in the Open and 800 in the Women's event.
- **The number of registered teams is 188 from 186 nations in the Open section and 162 from 160 nations in the Women's section. Both sections set team participation records.** Hence statement 2 is not correct.
- The main venue of the Chess Olympiad is the convention centre at the Four Points by Sheraton, while the opening and closing ceremonies will be held at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

Q 78.C

- **Dadabhai Naoroji**, reverentially remembered as the **Grand Old Man of India**, was an Indian political leader and was associated with the Indian National Congress since from its inception.
- Soon after graduation in 1845, he became the **first Indian to be appointed Professor at Elphinstone.** In 1867 he founded the **East India Association in London**, one of the predecessor organisations of the Indian National Congress with the aim of putting across the Indian point of view before the British public. In 1875 he was elected a **Member of the Municipal Corporation, Bombay.** In 1876 he resigned and left for London. He was appointed as Justice of the Peace in 1883, started a **newspaper called 'Voice of India'** and was elected to the Bombay Municipal Corporation for the second time. In 1885 he **joined the Bombay Legislative Council.** He also founded **Dnyan Prakas Mandali** and found Girls High school at Bombay.
- In 1885, when the **Bombay Presidency Association** came into being, he was elected as **one of its Vice - Presidents.** At the end of the same year, he took a leading part in the founding of the **Indian National Congress** and became its **President thrice in 1886, 1893 and 1906.**
- He was a firm believer in Parliamentary democracy. He is known in the history of Indian economic thought for his pioneering work in assessing India's national income. He was the **first Asian to be a British MP in 1892.** He stood several times for election to the House of Commons, facing considerable racism each time, finally being selected in 1892. During his time in the House of Commons Naoroji devoted his time towards improving the situation in India and campaigned for Indian independence. He was assisted in duties as an MP by Muhammed Ali Jinnah, the future Muslim nationalist and founder of Pakistan. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- Dadabhai Naoroji was conscious of the numerous benefits like modern education that the Indians derived from the British rule in India. He pledged "**loyalty to the backbone**" to the British crown and "**the permanent continuance**" of the British rule in India (**Calcutta session, 1886**). **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- In his many writings and speeches and especially in **Poverty and Un-British Rule in India (1901)**, Naoroji argued that India was too highly taxed and that its wealth was being drained away to England. He was a founding member of the **London Indian Society which was superseded by East India Association**, and became vocal in promoting Indian rights in regard to the ICS and trade.

Q 79.D

- The working conditions in factories and plantations in nineteenth-century India were miserable. Ironically, the first-ever demand for regulation of the condition of workers in factories in India came from the Lancashire textile capitalist lobby. They demanded the appointment of a commission for investigation into factory conditions. The first commission was appointed in 1875 although the first Factory Act was not passed before 1881.
- The Indian Factory Act, 1881 dealt primarily with the **problem of child labour** (between 7 and 12 years of age). Its significant provisions were:
 - employment of children under 7 years of age prohibited,

- **working hours restricted to 9 hours per day for children,**
- children to get four holidays in a month,
- hazardous machinery to be properly fenced off
- **The Indian Factory Act, 1891**
 - increased the minimum age (from 7 to 9 years) and the maximum (from 12 to 14 years) for children,
 - reduced maximum working hours for children to 7 hours a day,
 - **fixed maximum working hours for women at 11 hours per day with a one-and-a-half hour interval** (working hours for men were left unregulated). **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - provided weekly holiday for all
- **But these laws did not apply to British-owned tea and coffee plantations where the labour was exploited ruthlessly.**
- The early nationalists, especially the Moderates were indifferent to the labour's cause. They believed that labour legislations would affect the competitive edge enjoyed by the Indian-owned industries. Also, did not want a division in the movement on the basis of classes. **Hence, did not support the Factory Acts of 1881 and 1891 for these reasons. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 80.A

- **Aravipuram Movement was launched by Sri Narayana Guru on Shivaratri day of 1888. It was a reaction against Brahmanic supremacy and the caste system. Hence, statement 1 is correct and statement 2 is not correct.**
- Sri Narayana Guru defied the religious restrictions traditionally placed on the Ezhava community and consecrated an idol of Shiva at Aravipuram.
- The Aravipuram Pratistha was a historic event, because a member of a lower caste, forbidden from entering the temple, had himself consecrated the Shiva image in a temple.
- Millions saw Sri Narayana Guru as a saint, seer, philosopher, poet and social reformer. Education and organisation were amongst his many slogans for freedom and strength. He held that the essence of all religions is one and the same, and advocated the comparative study of all faiths.
- The organisation which he set up to maintain and manage the institutions he had founded later became known as Sri Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (Society for the Propagation of Sri Narayana Guru's Tenets).

Q 81.A

- The earliest expressions of opposition to **British rule in Tamil Nadu** came in the form of revolt of **Poligars (Palayakkarar) during the 18th century and which continued throughout till 1805.** The Palayakkarar system had evolved with the extension of Vijayanagar rule into Tamil Nadu. Each Palayakkarar was the holder of a territory or Palayam (usually consisting of a few villages), granted to him in return for military service and tribute. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The problem started in 1781, when the **Nawab of Arcot gave the management and control of Tinneveli and the Carnatic Provinces to the East India Company.** This arrangement caused resentment among the poligars who had, for long considered themselves as independent sovereign authorities within their respective territories. The Palayakkarars regarded themselves as independent, sovereign authorities within their respective Palayams, arguing that their lands had been handed down to them across a span of sixty generations. Such claims were brushed aside by the East India Company.
- Among the Palayakkarars, there were two blocs, namely the Western and the Eastern blocs. The Western bloc had Marava Palayakkarars and the Eastern bloc had Telugu Palayakkarars. Puli Thevar of Nerkkattumseval headed the former and Kattabomman of Panchalamkuruchi led the latter. **These two Palayakkarars refused to pay the kist (tribute) to the Nawab of Arcot and rebelled against the Company and the Nawab.** Hence, the issue of payment of tribute was **the root cause of rebellions.**
- **Yusuf Khan was the military commander employed by the British and the Nawab to curb the revolt of poligars.** The poligar rebellions were led by **Palayakkars like Kattabomma Nayak** who was the playakkarar of Panchalankurichi, **Puli Thevar** of Nerkkattumseval and **Marudu Pandyan of Sivaganga.** However, the rebellions were violently crushed by the British and the Palayakkarar (poligari) system was replaced by the Zamindari system. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 82.B

- The Gorkhas wrested control of Nepal from the successors of Ranjit Malla of Bhatgaon in 1760. They began to expand their dominion beyond the mountains. They found it easier to expand in the southern direction, as the north was well defended by the Chinese.
- In 1801, the English annexed Gorakhpur which brought the Gorkhas' boundary and the Company's boundary together. The conflict started due to the Gorkhas' capture of Butwal and Sheoraj in the period of

Lord Hastings (1813-23). **The war ended in the Treaty of Sagauli, 1816** which was in favor of the British. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

- The Treaty of Sagauli established the boundary line between Nepal and colonial India and was signed between the East India Company and the King of Nepal following the Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16.
 - The signatory for Nepal was Raj Guru Gajraj Mishra and the signatory for the Company was Lieutenant Colonel Paris Bradsaw.
- **As per the treaty,**
 - Nepal accepted a British resident.
 - Nepal ceded the districts of Garhwal and Kumaon, and abandoned claims to Terai.
 - Nepal also withdrew from Sikkim.
- **This agreement brought many advantages to the British:**
 - The British empire now reached the Himalayas;
 - It got better facilities for trade with Central Asia;
 - It acquired sites for hill stations, such as Shimla, Mussoorie and Nainital; and
 - The Gorkhas joined the British Indian Army in large numbers.

Q 83.C

- **Cryptojacking is a cyber attack wherein a computing device is hijacked and controlled by the attacker, and its resources are used to illicitly mine cryptocurrency. In most cases, the malicious programme is installed when the user clicks on an unsafe link, or visits an infected website — and unknowingly provides access to their Internet-connected device.**
- **Cryptojacking is a threat that embeds itself within a computer or mobile device and then uses its resources to mine cryptocurrency. Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
- Cryptojacking' attacks on computer systems have gone up by 30% to 66.7 million in the first half of 2022 compared to the first half of last year, according to a report by SonicWall, a US-based cybersecurity firm.
- "While volume increases were widespread, some business sectors were hit harder than others, such as the finance industry, which saw a rise of 269%," the report said.
- Coin mining is a legitimate, competitive process used to release new crypto coins into circulation or to verify new transactions. It involves solving complex computational problems to generate blocks of verified transactions that get added to the blockchain. The reward for the first miner who successfully manages to update the crypto ledger through this route is crypto coins.
- But the race to crack this 64-digit hexadecimal number code needs considerable computing power involving state-of-the-art hardware, and electrical power to keep the systems involved up and running.
- Cryptojackers co-opt devices, servers, and cloud infrastructure, and use their resources for mining. The use of 'stolen' or cryptojacked resources slashes the cost involved in mining.
- Hackers have two primary ways to get a victim's device to secretly mine cryptocurrencies:
- By getting the victim to click on a malicious link in an email that loads cryptomining code on the computer.
- By infecting a website or online ad with JavaScript code that auto-executes once loaded in the victim's browser.

Q 84.B

- **Warren Hastings was the first Governor-General of India (1772-85).** He transformed the East India Company from a trading organization into a great military and naval power. He established full-scale British civil administration in India.
- In what was to be the most constructive period of his administration, from 1772 to 1774, Hastings detached the machinery of the central government from the Nawab's court and brought it to the British settlement in Calcutta under direct British control, remodeled the administration of justice throughout Bengal, and began a series of experiments aimed at bringing the collection of taxation under effective supervision.
- **Significant events during the tenure of Warren Hastings**
 - Regulating Act of 1773
 - Act of 1781, under which the powers of jurisdiction between the governor-general-in-council and the Supreme Court at Calcutta, were clearly divided.
 - Pitt's India Act of 1784.
 - **The First Rohilla War of 1774.**
 - ✓ **It is a conflict in which Warren Hastings helped the nawab of Oudh defeat the Rohillas by lending a brigade of the East India Company's troops.**
 - The Rohillas were Afghans who had entered India in the 18th century during the decline of the Mughal Empire and gained control of Rohilkhand

- The First Maratha War in 1775–82 and the Treaty of Salbai in 1782.
- Second Mysore War in 1780–84.
- **Revolt of Chait Singh, the Maharaja of Benaras in 1781, which led to Hastings' impeachment in England.**
- **Foundation of the Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784).**
 - ✓ **Asiatic Society of Bengal, scholarly society founded on Jan. 15, 1784, by Sir William Jones, a British lawyer and Orientalist, to encourage Oriental studies.**
- **Vellore Mutiny, took place on July 10, 1806, by sepoys (Indian troops employed by the British) at Vellore (now in Tamil Nadu state, southern India).**
 - The incident began when the sepoys broke into the fort where the many sons and daughters of Tippu Sultan of Mysore and their families had been lodged since their surrender at Seringapatam in 1799 during the fourth Mysore War. The mutiny, though encouraged by the Mysore princes, was basically caused by resentment at new British regulations that ordered changes in headgear and shaving style and the prohibition of ornaments and caste marks for the Indian troops.
 - Little effort was made by the British to reassure the men or listen to their grievances, which included the belief that the regulations were detrimental to the religious practices of both Hindus and Muslims. There were also complaints about the sepoys' pay.
 - **Sir George Hilario Barlow served as Acting Governor-General of India** from the death of Lord Cornwallis in 1805 until the arrival of Lord Minto in 1807.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 85.A

- The Age of Consent Act, 1891, also known as Act X of 1891, was legislation enacted in British India in 1891 which **raised the age of consent for sexual intercourse for all girls, married or unmarried, from ten to twelve years** in all jurisdictions, its violation subject to criminal prosecution as rape. **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**
- While an 1887 case in a Bombay high court of a child bride Rukhmabai renewed discussion of such a law it was the death of an eleven-year-old Bengali girl Phulmoni Dasi in 1889 that drove intervention by the British. The act was passed in 1891.
- Behramji M. Malabari (1853- 1912) spoke vigorously against child marriage and widow remarriage among Hindus. **It was his efforts that led to the Age of Consent Act regulating the age of consent for females.**
- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak opposed the Age of Consent Bill.** His objection was mainly that such reforms must come from people governing themselves and not under an alien rule.
- **The Age of Consent Act was signed in 1891 during the viceroyship of Lord Lansdowne.**

Q 86.D

- **Subsidiary Alliance** was basically a treaty between the British East India Company and the Indian princely states, by virtue of which the Indian kingdoms lost their sovereignty to the English. It also was a major process that led to the building of the British Empire in India.
- **Features of the Subsidiary Alliance Treaty:**
 - An Indian ruler entering into Subsidiary Alliance with the British had to dissolve his own armed forces and accept British forces in his territory.
 - He also had to pay for the British army's maintenance. If he failed to make the payment, a portion of his territory would be taken away and ceded to the British. In return, the British would protect the Indian state against any foreign attack or internal revolt.
 - The British promised non-interference in internal affairs of the Indian state but this was rarely kept. The Indian state could not enter into any alliance with any other foreign power.
 - He could also not employ any other foreign nationals other than Englishmen in his service. The idea was to curb the influence of the French. The Indian state could also not enter into any political connection with another Indian state without British approval. The Indian ruler, thus, lost all powers in respect of foreign affairs and the military. He virtually lost all his independence and became a British 'protectorate'. A British Resident was also stationed in the Indian Court.
- The Indian princes who accepted the subsidiary system were: **the Nizam of Hyderabad (September 1798 and 1800)**, the ruler of **Mysore (1799)**, the ruler of Tanjore (October 1799), **the Nawab of Awadh (November 1801)**, the Peshwa (December 1801), the Bhonsle Raja of Berar (December 1803), the **Sindhia (February 1804)**, the Rajput states of Jodhpur, Jaipur, Macheri, Bundi and the ruler of Bharatpur (1818). The **Holkars** were the last Maratha confederation to accept the Subsidiary Alliance in **1818. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 87.C

- From 1878 onwards, the Government of India undertook a number of large-scale military expeditions outside India's frontiers and its armed forces were used in some of the wars waged by the British Government in Asia and Africa.
- Throughout the 19th century, the British Government was convinced that the extension of Russian influence over Central Asia constituted a real threat to its Indian domains. This had led Britain to first invade Afghanistan in 1839 with disastrous consequences. In 1876, the specter of Russian interference appeared once more when the Emir of Afghanistan, Sher Ali, was visited by a Russian diplomatic mission. When he then refused to accept a British envoy, the Viceroy of India, Lord Lytton, decided to act.
 - **Viceroy Lytton decided to launch the Second Anglo-Afghan War on November 21, 1878, with a British invasion.** Sher Ali fled his capital and country, dying in exile early in 1879. The British army occupied Kabul, as it had in the first war, and **a treaty signed at Gandamak on May 26, 1879, recognized Sher Ali's son, Ya'qub Khan, as emir.** He subsequently agreed to receive a **permanent British embassy at Kabul.** In addition, he agreed to conduct his foreign relations with other states in accordance "with the wishes and advice" of the British government.
- King Thibaw Min of Burma attempted to strengthen himself with the help of foreign powers. In **January 1855, Burma signed a trade treaty with France.** British had the monopoly over the trade in Burma and, in no case, were they prepared to share it with the French.
 - The English traders, therefore, put pressure on the English government to annex Burma to the British Empire. **The English government could not reject the demand of its trading community as it had sufficient control over the politics of the country. Thus by the end of 1885, the British attacked and annexed Burma.**
- **In 1903 Curzon decided to send a military expedition into Tibet led by Col. Francis Younghusband.** A brigade of Gurkhas and Tommies went over the Nathu La into the Chumbi valley and advanced unhindered till Xigatse.
 - A Tibetan military force met them there but offered what can only be described as passive resistance at a place called Guru near Gyantse. Not a shot was fired back as the British Indian troops rained bullets on them killing thousands. From Xigatse, Younghusband made a leisurely march into Lhasa.
 - **The British got the Tibetans to agree to end their isolation and having extracted trade concessions withdrew in 1904, the way they came. In 1907 Britain and Russia formally agreed that it was in their interests to leave Tibet "in that state of isolation from which, till recently, she has shown no intention to depart."**
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 88.A

- The **Indian National Congress (INC)** was **founded** in 1885 in Bombay. The first session of the Indian National Congress was attended by 72 delegates and presided over by **Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee**. However, there emerged several theories regarding the formation of INC. **W.C. Bonnerjee popularized the view that the idea of the Indian National Congress was a product of Lord Dufferin's brain**, that he suggested it to Mr Hume who undertook to work it out. Dufferin's idea was to have a political organisation through which the Government could ascertain the real wishes of the people and thus save the administration from any possible political outburst in the country. **It is believed that such a view was popularised to prevent the INC from attracting official wrath.**
- The **Safety Valve theory** advocates that **A. O. Hume a retired British official formed the Congress** with the idea that it would prove to be a 'safety valve' **for releasing the growing discontent of the Indians.** To this end, he convinced Lord Dufferin not to obstruct the formation of the Congress. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Many leaders including Lala Lajpat Rai believed in the Safety Valve theory. **Lala Lajpat Rai maintained that the Indian National Congress was organised to serve as a 'safety valve' for the growing unrest in the country and strengthen the British Empire.** According to him the redress of political grievances and political advance of India was only a by-product and of secondary importance. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 89.C

- After the second Anglo-Maratha war, the Marathas made one last attempt to rebuild their old prestige. The **Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–1819)** was the final and decisive conflict between the English East India Company and the Maratha Empire in India.
- Marathas wanted to retake all their old possessions from the English. They were also unhappy with the British resident's interference in their internal matters. The chief reason for this war was the **British conflict**

with the Pindaris whom the British suspected were being protected by the Marathas. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**

- The Peshwa was defeated at Khirki, Bhonsle at Sitabuldi, and Holkar at Mahidpur. Some important treaties were signed. These were:
 - June 1817, Treaty of Poona, with Peshwa.
 - November 1817, Treaty of Gwalior, with Sindhia.
 - January 1818, Treaty of Mandsaur, with Holkar.
- In June 1818, the Peshwa finally surrendered and the **Maratha confederacy was dissolved. The peshwaship was abolished.** Peshwa Bajirao became a British retainer at Bithur, near Kanpur. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The territories annexed from the Pindaris became the Central Provinces under British India.
- This war led to the end of the Maratha Empire. All the Maratha powers surrendered to the British. This was one of the last major wars fought and won by the British. With this, the British controlled most parts of India barring Punjab and Sindh directly or indirectly.

Q 90.B

- **Indian Councils Act, 1861** provided the appointment of **additional members for legislative purposes.** The viceroy could add six to twelve additional members, of whom at least half had to be **non-officials** who could be either Indian or English. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- However, the legislative council so constituted **possessed no real powers** and was merely advisory in nature. It could **not discuss important matters and no financial matters** at all without the previous approval of the Government. It had no control over the budget. Thus, it had **no voting powers over the budget.** **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- Before the adoption of the portfolio system in the Government of India, all Governmental business was disposed of by the Governor-General in Council. As the amount and complexity of the business of the Government increased, the work of the various Departments was distributed amongst the members of the Council (Portfolio system). **This procedure was legalized by the Indian Councils Act, 1861** during the time of Lord Canning, leading to the **introduction of the portfolio system** and the inception of the Executive Council of the Governor-General. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- The **Morley Minto Reforms of 1909 & not the Indian Councils Act of 1861**, for the **first time provided for the appointment of one Indian to the viceroy's executive council** (Satyendra Sinha was the first Indian to be appointed in 1909). It provided for the appointment of an Indian member to the Governor General Executive Council.

Q 91.C

- The government of India set up a famine commission under **Sir George Campbell after the Orissa famine of 1866-67. His report is considered as the first detailed report on the famine relief policy.**
- During the period of Lord Lytton, a **Strachey Commission of 1880 was created to develop a general strategy and principles to deal with the famines.** The Strachey Commission came out with the recommendation on whose basis a Famine Code was developed.
 - It was appointed after the famine of 1876-78 which affected Madras, Bombay, Uttar Pradesh, and Punjab.
- When the people were dying out of starvation and diseases, a **MacDonnell Commission was appointed for investigation of the 1899-1900 famine, by Lord Curzon** in 1901 which submitted its report in the same year. This commission came out with a "Moral Strategy", distribution of advances and loans to the peasants and setting up a Famine Commissioner in the famine-affected provinces
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 92.A

- Lord Cornwallis succeeded Warren Hastings as Governor-General in 1786.
- The internal reforms of Cornwallis can be studied under three main heads:
 - Administrative reforms
 - Revenue reforms
 - Judicial and other reforms
- **Administrative reforms:**
 - **Lord Cornwallis** was believed to have laid the foundation of British rule throughout India and various reforms into the court, revenue and services prevailed till the end of the British era in India.

- Cornwallis was determined to purify the administration, but he realized that the Company's servants would not give honest and efficient service so long as they were not given adequate salaries. He raised their salaries.
- He **enforced the rules against private trade and acceptance of presents** and bribes by officials with strictness. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Cornwallis also laid down that promotion in the Civil Services would be by **seniority**. So that, its members would remain independent of outside influence. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- **Lord Wellesly established the Fort William college** at Calcutta for the education of young recruits to the Civil Services. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Revenue reforms:**
 - Cornwallis introduced the **Permanent Settlement in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa in 1793**. 'Settlement' refers to the assessment and fixing of the quantum of land revenue to be paid by each zamindar to the government. For Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, this was fixed permanently. Thus the zamindars who were originally tax collectors acquired **hereditary rights** over the land assigned by the government. The zamindars pocketed whatever they collected over and above the settlement
- **Judicial and other reforms:**
 - At the top of the judicial system, the highest civil and criminal courts of appeal, namely Sadar Diwani Adalat and Sadar Nizamat Adalat were functioning at Calcutta.
 - **Indian judges or Munsiffs were appointed to all the courts at the bottom of the judicial system.**
 - Police reforms:
 - ✓ The District Judge controlled the police. Each district was divided into thanas or police circles each of which was about 20 square miles. It was placed under an Indian officer called the daroga who was ably assisted by many constables.

Q 93.A

- In order to establish civilian authority over the army, the **Charter Act of 1793** very clearly gave the **ultimate control** over all matters of war and peace to the **Board of Control**. The commander-in-chief was made subservient to the Governor General, but the functional relationship between the two always a sticky point ever since the beginning of the East India Company's army. This relationship continued to be unpleasant during the period of Crown rule, and became ugly during the notorious **Curzon- Kitchener controversy in 1904-05**.
- The military member in the Viceroy's Council, generally a senior officer of the army, served as the "eyes and ears" on all matters militaries for the Governor General. The **Commander-in-Chief, Lord Kitchener**, wanted to **abolish the position of the military member** in the viceroy's council (duality of control) and centralise control and command of the army in his own hands. In his opinion the post of military member could be easily dispensed with and his charter of responsibilities could be merged with that of the Commander-in-Chief. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Viceroy Lord Curzon objected** to it and when the home government offered a compromise formula of reducing the powers of the military member without abolishing the position, **he offered his resignation**. To his surprise, the **resignation was quickly accepted**, indicating the power of the army establishment. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- However later in **1905 the position of the military member was abolished** and the commander-in-chief became directly responsible to the viceroy's council. But the crucial **financial control of the army** was not left in his hands; for this a separate **Military Finance Department was created**, with a civilian chain of command going up to the Finance Member of the Council. This system remained in place until the end of colonial rule.

Q 94.C

- Maharaja Ranjit Singh, renowned as the Lion of the Punjab or Sher-e-Punjab was the great ruler and the founder of the Sikh kingdom of Punjab (1801-1839). Being continually busy in wars and entangled in politics, Ranjit Singh could not devote much time to establish any sound system of administration. The general **pattern of his administration was after the Mughal type** and Persian terminology was frequently adopted.
 - Ranjit Singh had divided his **kingdom into provinces**. All the provinces were not of uniform size. **Nazims or Subedars** were appointed to administer these provinces.
 - ✓ The office of Nazim being one of influence and power, was generally given to able and trustworthy persons.
 - ✓ The Nazims were paid fat salaries but they were not uniform in all the provinces.

- Each **province was divided into Parganas**, and each Pargana was divided into Taulqas and each Taulqa into 50 to 100 Mauzas or villages. **Each Pargana was under an official known as Kardar**. He was a revenue collector, a magistrate and a representative of the central authority all rolled in one. His **chief functions** were:
 - ✓ to collect revenue.
 - ✓ to maintain peace and order in the Pargana.
 - ✓ to act as a judge and magistrate and try cases according to his authority.
 - ✓ to enforce the orders of the Maharaja in the district.
 - ✓ The Kardar was also incharge of the treasury and performed duties of an accountant.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 95.B

- **The Santhal, who lived in the area between Bhagalpur and Rajmahal hills, known as 'Daman-i-koh', rose in revolt;** made a determined attempt to expel the outsiders the dikus, and proclaimed the complete 'annihilation' of the alien. In 1855, the Santhals gathered in the Bhagnadihi Village under the leadership of the brothers - Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu - and declared themselves free from the colonial rule. At the outset, the British rule was paralyzed in the area and the native agents were killed. The rebellion covering the districts of Birbhum, Singhbhum, Bankura, Hazaribagh, Bhagalpur, and Monghyr in Orissa and Bihar was precipitated mainly by economic causes. **This great insurrection is known as the 'Hul'. Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- **The Ramosi's, the hill tribes of the Western ghats had not reconciled to the British Rule and the British pattern of administration. They rose under Chittur Singh in 1822 and plundered the country around Satara.** Again, there were eruptions in 1825-26 and the disturbances continued till 1829. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
- **Munda Rebellion is one of the prominent 19th-century tribal rebellions in the subcontinent. Birsu Munda led this movement in the Chota Nagpur Plateau region south of Ranchi from 1899-1900. The ulgulan, meaning 'Great Tumult', sought to establish Munda Raj and independence. The Mundas traditionally enjoyed a preferential rent rate as the khuntkattidar or the original clearer of the forest.** But in course of the 19th century, they had seen this khuntkatti land system being eroded by the jagirdars and thikadars coming as merchants and moneylenders. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**
 - The government attempted to redress the grievances of the Mundas through the survey and settlement operations of 1902-10. The **Chhotanagpur Tenancy Act of 1908 provided some recognition to their khuntkatti rights and banned beth begari**. Chhotanagpur tribals won a degree of legal protection for their land rights.
- **The Koyas of the eastern Godavari track (now Andhra) revolted frequently against the administration aided by Khonda Sara leaders.** The revolt started against the 'Muttadars' (zamindars) who formed a chain of rent collectors from the colonial rulers in the year 1862.
 - The Britishers deprived the tribals of their traditional rights over the toddy trees -the most valuable property of the tribals for they yielded drinks. The traders from the region took advantage of the situation, by extending loans to the tribals they confiscated their produce and cattle.
 - As a result, the tribals attacked the authorities under the leadership of **Thamman-Dora** in 1879. Their grievances included police and moneylender persecution, new restrictions, and rejection of their traditional rights to forest regions. **Hence pair 4 is not correctly matched.**

Q 96.A

- **Vishnushastri Pandit** founded the Widow Remarriage Association in the 1850s in Bombay.
 - **The main task of this association was to make a concerted effort to eradicate people's apathy, cowardice, and bigotry standing in the way of the remarriage movement. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**
- Another prominent worker in this field was Karsondas Mulji who started the Satya Prakash in Gujarati in 1852 to advocate widow remarriage.
- **Pandit Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar** (1820-91), the principal of Sanskrit College, Calcutta, advocated for widow remarriage and due to his efforts that the Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act, 1856, was passed. It legalized the marriage of widows and declared issues from such marriages as legitimate. Vidyasagarcited Vedic texts to prove that the Hindu religion sanctioned widow remarriage.

Q 97.C

- **When the Indian National Congress (INC) was formed in 1885, it was led by ardent social reformers such as M.G.Ranade and R.Ragunath Rao who were under the impression that the Congress would be concerned with social, economic, and political issues.** However, it soon became clear that a strong faction in Congress was opposed to including social reform as part of the procedure.
- The gist of the argument was that social reform was divisive and contentious, whereas Congress's goal was political unity. As a result, social issues were omitted. **M.G.Ranade and R.Ragunath Rao's response to the INC's argument was the formation of the Indian Social Conference. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Indian Social Conference met for the first time in Madras in 1887.** M.G.Ranade's clear intention was to bind the social reform movement as closely as possible to Congress, even if it remained organizationally separate. It acts virtually as the social reform cell of the Indian National Congress. Later Ranade arranged sessions of the conference every year, immediately following the session of Congress, and at the same location. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- **The Conference's goal was to bring together representatives of progressive Indian opinion on social issues, much like the Indian National Congress did for politics.**
- The Conference's mission was to stimulate and strengthen the forces of reform by bringing together every year in mutual consultation representatives of the various associations and movements that, scattered across India, were struggling with social evils.
- **The Conference advocated intercaste marriages and opposed kulinism and polygamy. It launched the famous "Pledge Movement" to inspire people to take an oath to prohibit child marriage. Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 98.B

- **Space Situational Awareness (SSA) Observatory:** India's first commercial Space Situational Awareness (SSA) Observatory **will be set up in the Garhwal region of Uttarakhand.** The observatory will be set up by Digantara, a Bengaluru-based space sector start-up. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
- Space Situational Awareness, or 'SSA' means our ability to survey the space environment and safely operate within it. SSA involves the tracking of space objects, understanding their activities, monitoring space weather events, and identifying potential threats to space activities. SSA is generally understood as covering three main areas:
 - Space Surveillance and Tracking (SST) of man-made objects.
 - Space WEather (SWE) monitoring and forecast.
 - Near-Earth Objects (NEO) monitoring (only natural space objects).
- **Key points of the observatory:**
 - The observatory will be the first of its kind in the region, set up to augment the start-up's SSA capabilities.
 - It will be strategically positioned to serve global space traffic management operations.
 - It will assist in tracking any activity in space including that of space debris and military satellites hovering over the region.
 - At present, the US is a dominant player in monitoring space debris.
 - The observatory will bring value to the nation by serving as an essential data source for advancing knowledge of the realm of space.
 - It will be able to supplement its space-based sensors in its mission to monitor satellites and debris in orbits ranging from Low Earth Orbit (LEO) to Geosynchronous Earth Orbit (GEO).

Q 99.B

- Zimbabwe's central bank has announced to start selling gold coins, as a store of value to tame runaway inflation, which has considerably weakened the local currency. The coins will be available for sale from July 25 in local currency, US dollars, and other foreign currencies at a price based on the prevailing international price of gold and the cost of production.
- The "Mosi-oa-tunya" coin, named after Victoria falls, can be converted into cash and be traded locally and internationally.
- Gold coins are used by investors internationally to hedge against inflation and wars.
- Zimbabwe abandoned its inflation-ravaged dollar in 2009, opting instead to use foreign currencies, mostly the U.S. dollar. The government reintroduced the local currency in 2019, but it has rapidly lost value again.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 100.C

- Jamnalal was born in 1889 in Rajasthan near Sikar. He was born in a well-off Aggarwal family. He was adopted as the grandson by a rich and famous trader in British India, Seth Bajaj, and his wife. Jamnalal established what would become the Bajaj group of industries in 1926. During WWI, the British government appeased and honoured native tradesmen to raise finances. Jamnalal was made an honorary magistrate.
 - In the 1920s, though, when India was fighting for independence, Jamnalal Bajaj emerged as an **ethical entrepreneur who was dubbed the 'Merchant Prince' by Mahatma Gandhi.**
- He participated in the Non-co-operation Movement in 1921, the **Nagpur Jhanda Satyagraha in 1923** to uphold the honour of our National Flag, the Boycott of Simon Commission in 1929, the Salt Satyagraha in 1930, and the Anti war campaign in 1941.
- He was the one leader who was simultaneously active in the struggles in the princely states – leading the Jaipur Satyagraha in 1939 as also bringing to resolution struggles in Bijolia and Sikar.
- But it was in implementing the Constructive Programme of Gandhiji that Jamnalalji overreached himself. As the **Founder-President of the 'Gandhi Seva Sangh' and Chairman of the 'All-India Khaddar Board'** he undertook an extensive khadi tour first in Rajasthan followed by the entire country.
- He played a pivotal role in the establishment of the Sevagram ashram at Wardha in 1936. He was responsible for setting up Gandhi's residence at Sevagram in 1936 which eventually took the shape of an Ashram.
 - The last of the Ashram that Gandhi founded **was Sevagram Ashram.** When Gandhi was 67 years, he reached the village called Shegaon, near about 8 km from Wardha on the 30th April, 1936, remained here for about five to six days. He called the villagers and sought their permission to settle down here. He had no intention to keep anybody with him except his wife Kasturba. However, the slow pressure of work necessitated permission to more colleagues until Sevagram Ashram also became a full-fledged institution.
 - **Jamnalal Bajaj** made available to the ashram about 300 acres of land on the outskirts of the village.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**